Journal of a Journey in a Canoe from Cumberland House, by the Frog Portage by the Grey Deers Lake & to the Athapescow thro' Lake Wollaston, & return back by the same way; & from the Entrance of Deers River, down the Missin nippe or Churchill River, to Fort Prince of Wales - by Peter Fidler.

1807 June 2nd Tuesday - at noon, myself, James Haroweck Steersman, Wm Dunnett Bowsman & John Ross Middleman - Embarked from Cumberland House in a Middle sized Canoe - in order to survey the Track from the Frog Portage or a thake a sake a pet che caw, to the Athapescow Lake, by the way of Grey Deers Lake - and from the entrance of Deers river down the Missinnippe, or Churchill River to Churchill Factory. - we took with us provisions, 6 bags of Pemmican of 75 lb each - put up half way thro' Cumberland House Lake as I had formerly Surveyed this same track we are now going in 1792, between Cumberland & the Frog Portage - I now omit it - & my present survey will commence at that Portage.
3rd Wednesday - at 4 AM Embarked & arrived at the Portage in the Sturgeon Weir river at 8 ½ am - put up within 2 Hours work of the Beaver Lake at 7 ½ Pm - water fallen 2 feet perpendicular in this River since last Year when it was the highest ever known - all thro' these Northern parts.
4th Thursday - Embarked at 4 AM & put up at the Pelican Lake at 6 Pm. Saw a few Southern Indians from whom I traded a few Beaver Skins. -
5th Friday - Got underway at 4 AM & arrived at the Birch Carrying Place at 8 am - here we met Mr William Tomison, 2 Men & an Indian boy as Pilot, going in a Canoe from Duck Lake where he wintered, to Cumberland House for Provisions - to serve the Churchill Boats Crews down to the Factory

June. there was also 1 Canoe here belonging the Canadians, from the Deers Lake with 21 Packs of Furs - remained with Mr Tomison 1 ½ hour, gave him a Supply of Provisions to put him to Cumberland, as they was very near destitute of any thing to eat. - proceeded onwards & put up in the narrow beyond the Stony Lake at 7 ½ Pm. - saw a deal of Ice in this Lake. - Passed by a Canadian House built last fall near the Pine Carrying Place.

6th Saturday - Embarked at 4 ½ AM. 2 Hours after met Mr McLeod, Stewart & McKenzie - in one Canoe from the Athapescow Lake, from one of them I learn that their returns in Furs from their Settlements to the North of the Methy Carrying Place has been this Winter the greatest by far ever known amounting to 850 Packs - whereas the other Year 1799 when the greatest returns came out only was then 648 Packs. - The Spring has been early there contrary to what we have had in more Southern Latitudes. - Met Mr John Wills a little farther on, with 2 Canoes - in the Woody Lake passed Mr Frobisher & 5 Canoes from the Isle a la Crosse - arrived at the Frog Portage at 7 ½ Pm. & put up - water fallen here since last Summer 4 Feet 9 Inches - Found here a Young Jepowyan or Northern Indian, whom I engaged to pilot us to the Deers Lake House where Mr Joseph Spence winters - as none of us know any thing of the road - to give him 1 ½ yd Cloth, ½ lb Gunpowder - 1 lb Shott 20 Ball & 3 Feet of Tobacco. - he had lately come from Deers Lake as Pilot for a Canadian Master, & was promised payment but got nothing. -

7th Sunday - Rain until noon, when we Embarked, & proceeded down the Missinnippe or Churchill River, as under. NbW 1 – NWbN 1 – NbE 1 ½ – NE ½ E 4 – NE 1 a narrow - NEbN ½ - ENE ½ - EbS ¾ - ENE ¼ a narrow – NEbN 2 - NbE 4, these 2 last Courses near ½ mile wide - NE 1 ½ across a small Lake - NNE ¼ - EbS ⅛ & carried on the North Side 140 yds a bad Track - This is called the Kettle Fall - very steep & about 14 Feet Perpendicular put up here at 8 PM - Strong wind a head all afternoon which delayed us

1807

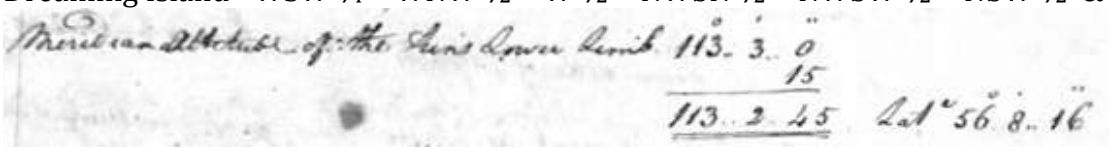
June 8th Monday - at 4 ½ AM, Embarked & proceeded down the Missinnippe NEbN 1 ¼ - NbE 1, and came to the Entrance of Deers River which we go up - leaving Churchill River on our right - a small rapid just below the Kettle Fall - all the rest of the river is smooth water like a Lake, except in the narrows where sometimes there is a strong current. - rocky sides, well covered with Pine, Birch, Poplar & Willows the most common wood of these parts of the Country - went up Deers River as under (all the Courses are P[er] Compass exclusive of Variation & the Distances set down are all estimated which are afterwards corrected by the Observed Latitudes & Variation) - NbW 2 - N ½ near ½ mile wide no perceptible Current - here we came to a Strong Rapid a small Island in the middle of the river, we hauled up the Canoe on the East side, altho' in general when the water is low there is a Portage on the same side of 70 Yards - River here about 200 Yards wide with pretty strong current in Places low grassy willowy sides. NbE ½ - NbW ½ – W ⅛ - NbW ½ - NbE ½ - now turns wider NNW 1 ½ - NNE ½

Double meridian altitude of the ☉ ☌ ☾ 110°. 36'. 0"
15
Latitude 55°. 40'. 48" 110°. 35'. 45"

Taken 17th July on our Return - NbW 1 these 2 last Courses ¾ mile wide a Small river falls in on the West side near where the Observation was taken - N 2 - NbW 2 - NbE 3 - NE 1 ½ - ENE ½ , these last 5 Courses from ½ to 1 mile wide, no perceptible Current - N 1 - NbW 1 - NNE ½ a narrow & strong current - NEbN ¾ - NEbN 1 ¼ - NEbN 1 from Point to point along a Small kind of a Lake from 3 to ½ mile wide NNW 1 - NbE ½ - N 1 ½ - NW 1 - NWbW 1 ½ & put up at 7 ½ Pm. these last courses from ¼ to ¾ mile wide. - passed by several Canoes of Northern Indians [Dené] who have lately come from the Deer Lake House - got from them a little meat and One Bear Skin. - one of these people joined us at night to conduct us to the House - he had been waiting at the Mouth of this river, but as we did not arrive there before the 1st June he left the Place -

1807

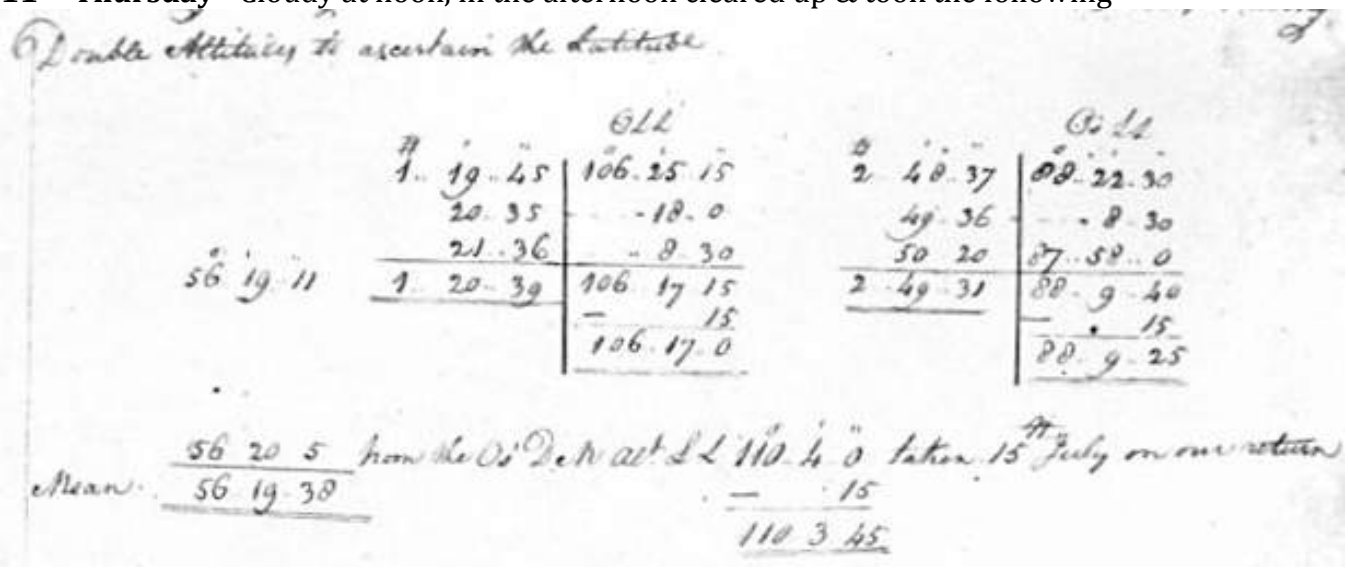
June 9th Tuesday - at 4 ½ AM got underway & proceeded up the Deers river as Yesterday. WSW ½ - SWbW ¾ 50 Yards wide & strong current - NWbN ⅓ - SWbS ½ - WbS 1 & carried over a steep hill on the East side 180 Yards good road - the fall about 12 Feet perpendicular. - NNW 1 nearly 2 Miles wide Woppis cone river falls in on the West Side, which falls out of a pretty large Lake of the same Name about 20 off - NNW 1 - NNW ½ - NNE ¾ & went on the East side a large Island - ENE ⅛ - N ¾ - N ½ - NNW ¾ - NbW ¾ - 1 ½ miles wide & entered a narrow NNW ¼ - NW ¼ - NWbW 1 ¼ - NWbN 1 ½ - these two courses a kind of Lake 1 ¼ mile wide - & enter a narrow WNW ⅛ WNW ½ - now enter a kind of narrow river about 40 Yards wide & go thro it the following courses NbW ¾ - NW ¼ - SWbS ¼ a small Is^d called Dreaming Island - WSW ¼ - WNW ½ - W ½ - NWbN ½ - NWbW ½ - NbW ½ & took the


Meridian Altitude of the Sun's Lower Limb 113° 3′ 0″
15
113° 2′ 45″ Lat° 56° 8′ 16″

NWbN ½ - N ½ - NbW ½ - NWbN ½ - NWbW ¼ - NNW ¼ - N ¼ - NbW ¼ - NNE ¼ & entered a Small Lake N 1 ¼ - then narrow between rocks NE ¼ - ESE ⅛ about 30 Yards & a strong rapid, hauled up the Canoe - tho in general they carry on West side about 50 Yards - NbE ½ & enter a kind of Lake from ½ to 3 miles wide. NNE 1 a good creek on West side - NW 1 ½ & carried on the West side 340 Yards pretty good road - the fall here is about 14 Feet in 2 hinks, then continued thro a small Lake NWbN 3 miles - & became narrow with pretty strong current. WNW ½ - WSW ¾ - NW ⅛ & carried over an Is^d near the North side 55 Yards good - the fall about 7 Feet. - now we enter a kind of Lake nearly 2 miles wide WNW ½ W 1 ½ - NWbN 1 - NNW ½ & enter a narrow. N 1 ½ , the Old French House formerly here - now we enter into the Grey Deers Lake NW ¼ - WNW 1 - WbS 1 & arrived at the House at 7 ½ Pm - Found Mr Joseph Spence here & 2 Men, all well - a great deal of Ice yet in sight - Very small pine & Birch in the Deers river, with rocky shores but very little current except a little in the narrows - Not a tree is to be found hereabouts of more than 6 Inches Diameter. - & very stunted

June 10th Wednesday - Several Jepowyans at the House - the only Indians who trade here one of which is engaged to pilot us to the Athapescow Lake, or until we meet with others, to continue forwards with us - Cloudy Weather. -

11th Thursday - Cloudy at noon, in the afternoon cleared up & took the following


Double Altitudes to ascertain the Latitude

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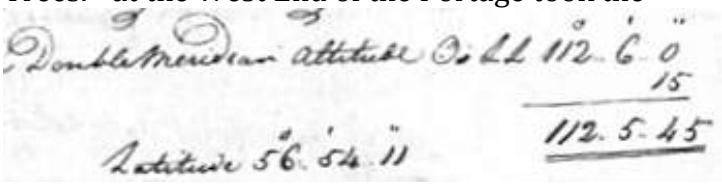
	1 19 45	106 25 15		2 48 37	88 22 30
	20 35	- 18 0		49 36	- 8 30
	21 36	- 8 30		50 20	87 58 0
56 19 11	1 20 39	106 17 15		2 49 31	88 9 40
		— 15			— 15
		106 17 0			88 9 25

56 20 5 from the ⊙'s Dec. N at ☾ 110 4 0 taken 15th July on our return
Mean 56 19 38 — 15
110 3 45

Got every thing in readiness to proceed for the East End of the Athapescow Lake tomorrow also got a small supply of Trading goods in case we meet with any of the Natives which we expect - .

12th Friday - Early this morning sent away the Pilot & one of our Men, in a Small Canoe, to see if the Ice will permit us to proceed at 11 they returned & says that the Ice out in the Lake is much - & he proposes for us to go another way to avoid being detained with the Ice, it is along a narrow deep bay of this Lake & over a height of Land. - at 11 ⅓ am we Embarked an Elderly Man as Pilot accompanying us with another stout Jepowyan young Man - Calm weather - went as under in Deers Lake NE ¾ - NEbN ½ - NNE 1 ½ - NbE 1 - NNE 5 N 4 here we enter a bay & continue down it - the Lake being on our right hand - NNW 3 ½ - NNW 1 ½ - NbW 2 - N ¾ - NNW ¾ - NbW 4 - NbW 7 - NbW ½ W 3 - NbW 4 - NNW ½ - N ¾ - NNW 2 & put up at 7 ½ Pm - at a narrow place between rocks about 10 Yards wide called by the Jepowyan Theon collin call - Rocky shores in General all along the Lake with small Pine & Birch - deep clear water. - Saw no Ice - This bay is from 5 or 6 miles to 1 wide -

June 13th Saturday at 3#..55' AM Embarked & went along the Bay as Yesterday - as follows N ½ - WNW 1 ½ a heavy fall close on our left at the mouth of a small river, that forms this bay here - NNW 1 - NNW 1 ½ - NbW ½ W 1 ¼ - NbW ½ - NbW 1 ½ - NNW 2 - N 1 - N ¼ a narrow of 40 Yards wide - NEbN ½ a branch on the right hand - NNW ⅛ - & entered a Small Lake nearly 1 mile wide N ½ & carried over a height of Land at the very bottom of the Bay into another Large Lake 1560 Yards - 100 Yds at the East End & 640 at the West End a Deep bad swamp - the middle hard dry Ground - the Track for carrying the Indian small Canoes thro is very narrow, which occasioned our clearing & cutting down many small Trees. - at the West End of the Portage took the

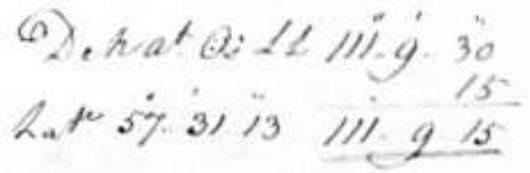


at 1 Pm got underway in the Lake - a strong wind ahead, obliged to put up for wind at 3 Pm after going the following Courses - NW ⅛ - NNW 2 - NNW 3 - NbW ½ NWbN ½ N 1 ½ - NWbN ½ - SW ¾ .

14th Sunday at 5 am the Wind rather abated & we got underway in the same Lake NbW ½ - NW 1 ½ - N ¼ - NWbN ¾ - WSW 1 & entered a narrow about 300 Yards wide SWbW 1 ¼ - SWbW 3 - SWbS ¼ here not more than 5 Yards wide with strong rapid - the current runs the same way we are going - ent^d a Small Lake about 3 miles wide, went thro it SWbW 1 ½ - WSW ½ & carried 25 Yards over a narrow neck of Land, the point extending 2 or 3 miles farther or more by the Account of our Guide, then down a river at first near ½ mile wide, afterwards in places not more than 10. - NNE ½ - NNW ½ - NbW 1 - NbE ¼ a bad rapid 40 Yds long. - NbE ¼ - NWbW ¼ a small rapid - N ¼ - NNE ½ & carried on the North Side 430 Yards good road - NW ¼ - NNE ½ & carried 640 Yards on the South Side swampy in places at the upper end - a Stout creek falls in on the right at the bottom of the Rapid - NWbN ⅛ - NNE 1 - N ¼ - NW ¼ - two Creeks fall in on the South or left side - N ¼ - ESE ⅛ & carried on the North 120 Yards good road, a perpendicular fall of 7 Feet - - NNE ¼ - E 1/16 - NNW 1 river here ¼ Mile wide & Low rocky Country & entered a kind of Lake but the wind would not permit us to paddle in it, so put up at 7 ½ Pm - I angled several Trout - Lay by for rain 2 Hours. - also lost 1 hour more in finding the Portage of 25 Yds over the Point in the Lake.

June 15th Monday - at 6 ½ AM got underway - & went in a kind of Lake ½ mile wide N ½ E 8 - NbE 2 ½ - NEbN ¾ Paint River falls in on the left in a bay ½ mile deep - Canoe building point on the right - NE ¾ - ENE 1 - NNE 3 - NNE 1 - NbE 1 - NEbN 1 ½ - E ½ - SE ½ - SSW ½ - NE ½ these 4 last courses narrow & pretty strong current EbS ¾ - NEbE ½ - NNE 2 - NNE 1 ½ this river forms here into two branches, we took the North one & go down it NbW 1 - NW ½ - NbE 1 - NNW 1 - N ¾ an opening on our right into Deers Lake - SW ⅛ - N ⅛ - NE ¼ a large opening into Deers Lake - keep along the Lake from point to point on the West side - NbW ½ - NbW 1 & enter a narrow formed by a large Island on our right - it is at this place that we begin to return back thro the Deers Lake. - NWbN ½ - NNE 1 ½ - N ¼ - N ¾ - NW ½ - W 1 ¼ - WNW ⅓ - WSW ½ - SW ⅛ & entered Canoe river, shoal & narrow with a strong rapid at the mouth, put up on an Isd at the head of the rapid at 7 ½ Pm -

16th Tuesday - poled, Paddled & hauled up the Canoe river WSW ⅓ a steep rapid - led up on the South Side - WSW ¼ all a shoal rapid - broke our Canoe which detained us 1 hour in repairing - NWbW ¼ - NNE ¼ - W ½ - NNE ¾ a steep rapid led up on N Side 20 Yards - N 1 this reach 300 Yds wide & shoal - NNE ⅛ - W ¼ about 20 Yards wide, pretty easy current between the rapids - WNW ¼ - W ¼ - NW ¼ - NbE ¾ - NbW ⅛ - NNE ¾ - NbW ¼ - NbE ¼ & carried on S Side 510 Yards over a small hill - swampy at lower end. - SW ¼ & carried on the North Side 630 Yards pretty good road - near SWbW ½ a small Creek on the South Side - near N 2 - SW ¼ - WSW ¼ - W ½ an Island. - NW ¼ - NE ⅛ - NWbW ½ - & carried on the South side 640 Yards swampy & bad in many places - SW ⅛ - S ⅛ a small Creek on the South Side - NbW ⅛ NNE ⅛ a small rapid - WbN ¼



NW ⅛ - WSW ⅛ a rapid led up the Canoe, the Indian portage on the South side is 470 Yards long, these Portages below in this river we might have hauled up but our Guide told us they were Portages, which we carried at without going to examine the rapids - on our return we did not carry at any of them. - SW ¼ a shoal rapid 150 Yds long - SW ½ still water - & came to another bad rapid 300 Yds long a little above it another bad rapid - so we made one Carrying place to shun them both of 1290 Yds into a Small Lake - about 2 ½ Miles wide, which we coasted quite round, our Guide not knowing the direct way out of it -

1807

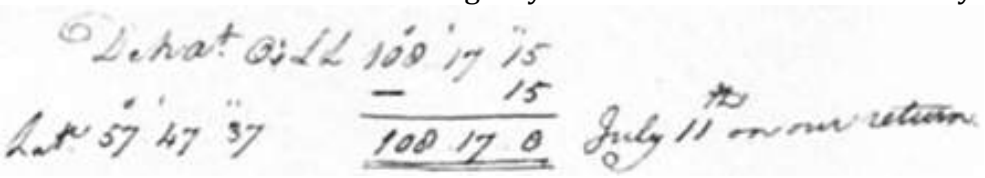
June - went thro' the Small Lake NNW 1 - NEbN ¾ a narrow ½ mile wide - then opens again - NbW ½ a small river falls from the West into this Lake - N ½ W 1 to an Island - NbE ½ & entered the Canoe river again, which is now very crooked & narrow - NbE 1/10 to - between SbW to SE on the right hand 3 ½ miles - a small rapid - Went 1 ½ mile crooked as before, a pretty steep rapid - river about 10 Yds wide, steep banks - with thick woods close to the Waters edge - little or no Current & about 6 Feet deep - went ¾ mile as before & came to a Steep rapid carried every thing on the South Side 560 Yards pretty good - Course from the Lake below to this portage about WbN 2 miles –

Dist. Gill 108. 23. 0
— 15
Lat. 57. 36. 46 108. 22. 45 July 12th on our return.

Put up at the upper end of the Carrying Place at 7 ½ Pm. -

17th 18th & 19th - Wednesday - at 4#..35' AM got underway - & hauled up the Canoe Rivulet NNW ¼ - 2 ½ miles making WSW 1 - from N on the right to SE on the left 2 ½ miles making SWbS 1 ½ - 3 miles making WbN 1 ½ - 2 miles making WNW ¾ - 1 ½ mile making N ½ a Small Lake & Rocks on the North side - NbE ½ - not so very crooked as before 3 miles making NW 2 & came to a Steep rapid, carried on the N Side good - sandy & Firs 1020 Yards - N ⅛ a Small ripple - 3 miles near NNW making 2 Miles two Islands in the river, behind one of them on the South Side is a Carrying Place into a Small Lake of 600 Yds Good Road - we proceeded up the river 2 Miles farther, our Pilot not knowing the Way. - we was very frequently lost the remainder of this Day & the two following, having nearly the whole of the following small Lakes to walk round before we could find the Carrying places from one to another, therefore continue the whole 3 Days under one. Leave the River (which above is very full of bad Rapids) & carry 600 Yds good road into a Small Lake 1 mile wide & 2 long - went thro' it SWbW 1 ¼ mile & carried 220 Yards a deep swamp & bad into another Lake 2 ½ miles long by 1 ½ wide, went along it WbS ½ & carried out of it into another 230 Yards pretty good Road. - then entered another small Lake & paddled the long way of it NW ¼ - NNE ½ about ¾ mile wide & carried 240 Yards into another small Lake - boggy & bad

June 18th of the East end is a deep swamp - the rest hard dry ground - Went thro' another Small Lake NW ¾ & ⅓ mile wide, & came to another Carrying place 1050 Yards over, pretty good road - & entered a Larger Lake, that the Canoe river falls out off. went along it NWbN 2 nearly 3 miles wide - & entered a narrow about ¼ mile wide & went along it NWbW ¼ - NbE 3 ½ - SW ¼ & entered a small Creek –
19th very shoal & stony 200 Yards long, hauled the Canoe thro it - no current in it - and entered a Small Lake ½ mile wide & went the Long way of it N 1 mile & came to a Carrying Place –



Carried 1800 Yards, very swampy & bad in many places - & entered another Small Lake ½ mile wide & 2 miles Long, went thro it NWbN ½ - WbN ½ & carried 1200 Yards, very swampy in places, & came to another small Lake about ½ mile Diameter went across it W ⅕ & carried 370 Yards, to the Edge of a Very Large Lake which I have denominated Lake Wollaston in Honour of Mr Wollaston a member of the Committee of the Honorable Hudson's Bay Company. - & put up at the Edge of the Lake at 8 ½ Pm - all of us being very much fatigued in finding out the Portages - as our Guide never saw this place but one when a Boy upwards of 30 Years ago - & then in the Winter - the Tracks over the Portages being very little used - we were obliged to clear many small trees away. - Before the Canadians settled in the Athapescow all the Southern, & some Beaver & Northern Inds used annually to pass this way in great numbers on their way down to Churchill to Trade - We are now at the Height of Land two small rivers falling out of Lake Wollaston, one of which empties its waters in to the Hyperborean or Frozen Ocean, & the other into Hudsons Bay at Churchill. - Set the Woods on Fire in several places as a Signal the Indians whom we expect to meet in this Lake - our Guide is now become heartily tired of his Journey & wishes much to leave us - so that we are under the Necessity of watching him in the Night

June 20th Saturday - At 5 ½ AM got underway & went in Lake Wollaston as under - WbS ½ - SWbS 2 - WNW 2 ½ - thro a narrow SSW ⅛ - WSW ⅛ & opening NWbW 2 a fine sandy point on an Island - saw a Smoke & paddled toward it, but as we was at last enclosed in a Bay - our Guide said he would walk to it by Land - he took his little all out of the Canoe, and was just setting off accompanied by the Young Man - but fearing they would not return to us again - I was under the necessity of compelling them to Embark - & continued on NWbW 1 ½ - WNW 1 - NWbN 3 - NNW ½ - WNW 2 - NWbN 1 to the East side of a very Large Island, went along the same side N 1 ¼ - NbE 1 ½ three Small Islands & put up on one of them at 9 Pm - to keep our Pilot from Deserting us as he is now more than ever averse to accompany us - wishing to get soon back to his Family he left at our House at the Deers Lake -

21st Sunday - Gave our Guide a little Liquor last Night to cheer up his Spirits - that it was 7 AM before we got underway. - & continued in this Lake Wollaston NbE 2 - NbE 1 ½ - N 1 - NbW ½ NNW ½ - NbW 2 to the Northern extremity of the Large Island, NNE 1 mile to an Island where we found much Ice - every one having a pole in his hand we pushed the Canoe thro' it about ½ mile when we came to Clear water. - WNW 8 No Land in Sight from the NW to NNE & in several places towards the South this is a very extensive Lake - very deep, clear water, very rocky shores & very small Pines - an excellent Place for great plenty of very fine Tickameg & Large Trout. - This Last course brot us to a pretty Large Island - went along it N 1 and took several Observations here on our return July 10th - which follow on the other side -

1807

July 10th

Dev at Gill 107°. 50'. 45"
— 15
107 50 30 Lat 58° 8'. 28"

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	2. 46	54. 30		
	3. 33	55.. 0		
	4. 26	55. 30		
	5. 15	56.. 0		
	6.. 4	56. 15		
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	0.. 5.. 58	69.. 55. 13		
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		Point		
+ 66	1. 32.. 13	70.. 40.. 30		
	33. 12	41.. 0		
	34. 2	41. 15		
	34.. 49	41. 45		
	35. 34	42.. 0		
	36. 23	42. 30		
	37. 13	42.. 45		
	38. 17	43.. 15		
	39.. 44	43. 30		
	39. 45	44.. 0		
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	1.. 46.. 48	70.. 42.. 0	103. 4½	
		Point		
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	43. 45	40.. 15		
	44. 32	40. 45		
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	46.. 40	41.. 45		
	47. 25	42.. 0		
	48.. 8	42.. 15		
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	51. 31	37. 15		
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	+ 10.. 43	— 15		
	2.. 2.. 13	95.. 27.. 15		
		Sun		
+ 56	3.. 51.. 2	68.. 2.. 15		
	51. 44	67. 50. 45		
	52. 28	39. 30		
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		Point		
	0. 12. 48	70.. 0.. 45		
	14. 12	1. 15		
	15. 8	1. 45		
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	17. 3	2. 30		
	17. 55	3. 0		
	18. 52	3. 30		
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	22. 2	5.. 15		
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		Dble. Alt. Sun		
	1.. 53. 21	96.. 9.. 0		
	54. 6	0. 45		
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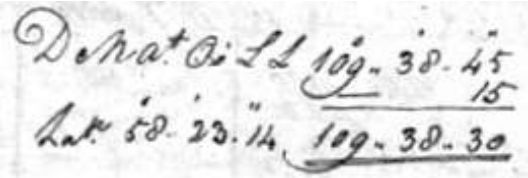
	1.. 54. 9	96.. 0.. 15		
	+ 10. 46	— 15		
	2.. 4.. 55	96.. 0.. 0		
		Sun		
	3.. 53. 28	68.. 27.. 0		
	54. 17	14. 0		
	55. 3	2. 45		
	3.. 54. 16	68.. 14. 35		
	+ 10. 53	— 15		
	4.. 5. 9	68.. 14.. 20		

HUDSON'S BAY COMPANY

Bg an amplitude at 0wet July 8th variation of the compass 18°..27' Easterly
Mean of the Whole 103°..7'..0"

June 21st - NW 1 ¼ & came to the West point of observation Island. - NW 3 a Small Isd. which our Guide set fire to, - WbS 5 - W 2 - W 1 near burnt wood, here we found the Tracks of Several Indians - lately gone away - NE ¾ - N ½ - NNE 3 - NNE 1, a high Isd close on our right we out to have gone for, from Observation Isd about NW. - Made another Large Smoke which was immediately answered by another from the Indians - which was a little to the left of our Course - made for it. - no Land in sight in many places from the NW to NE - paddled till Sun Set & put up, 3 Indians came to us - 6 Tents of them are on another Island about 4 miles off - our Guide went to them. -

22nd Monday - at Sunrise embarked and went to the Jepowyans. - 6 Tents. Traded from them near 50 MB - also a Canoe to carry our Guide back to the Deers Lake - & engaged another to conduct us to the Athapescow Lake called J ell lah - the Young man still continues with us, who came from Deers Lake - Gave all the Inds small presents, also a Geenah Thechigh one of the Men who accompanied Mr Hearne to the Coppermine River To give our new Guide 1 Gun - 50 Ball 1 Quart Powder - ½ Yd Cloth, a Mans Cloth Coat - 4 lb Shott - 2 Knifes - 4 Flints & 1 fathom of Tobacco - left the Indians at 9 ½ AM - Course from where the Fire was last made to the next Point in the Direct road is NWbW 5



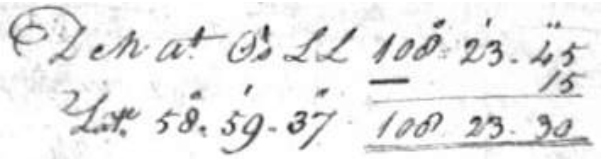
N 4 ½ - NNW 1 - NWbN ½ & entered the Hatchet River, & go now before the current. - Lake Wollaston extends about 50 Miles to the South of our Track by the Indian Account & nearly 20 to the North of it - very few Islands in it, quite open - which requires calm weather to pass thro' it - the Entrance of Hatchet River is about 300 Yds wide - little or no current NWbN 2 - NW ½ - WbN 1 ¼ & came to a shoal stony

June ripple, with very slippery large flat Stones - hauled the Canoe over it about 100 Yards - NW ½ & becomes a small Lake from ¼ to 2 Mile wide in places, all the way to the next ripple - WbN 1 - NWbN 1 - NbE 1 - SWbS 1, SbW ½ an other shoal ripple, rather steep at the lower end - about 300 Yards long - river here about 50 Yards wide - a thicket of willows on both sides - WbS ¼ - S ⅛ - WbS ½ - NNE ¾ , now the river becomes very crooked, short turning - 1 ½ mile making NEbE ½ - WSW ½ - N ½ & a pretty deep rapid 50 Yards long lowered down the Canoe - ¾ mile crooked making NNE ½ & entered the Little Hatchet & went in it as under NNE ¼ - WbS ¾ & put up on a Small Island at 6 Pm - too much Swell in the Lake to proceed. -

23rd Tuesday - At 4 AM Embarked & went in Little Hatchet Lake - as below - NWbN ¼ - WNW 1 - NWbW ¼ - NW ½ - NWbW ¾ - NWbN ¾ - NW ½ - NWbN 2 - NbW ¼ - NbW ½ - WbN 1 - SW ½ - WNW ¾ - WNW ½ & entered another river - in a Shoal strong long rapid - a small branch falling in on the right ½ mile below the Head of it - The Little Hatchet Lake is from 1 ½ to 9 miles wide - with a great many Islands of Pine rocky shores - pretty deep & clear water. - Down the river N ⅛ NW ¼ a strong rapid - NW ¼ easy Current - & came to a Small Lake went along it WNW 1 - SW 2 - WSW ½ & carried on the South side 250 Yards a strong crooked rapid, good carrying - NWbW ½ - NW ½ very narrow N ⅛ - NW ¼ & carried on S Side 390 Yards, stony. - & entered a small Lake from 1 ½ to 300 Yds wide went down it WbS 1 ½ - N 1 - SW ⅛ - SW ¼ - SWbS 1 WSW ½ - N 2 - WNW ½ - a strong rapid, led down the Canoe - a good Track on the South Side - shoal & spreads wide at bottom - NbW ½ two rapids of 40 Yds each lowered down them. - N ⅛ - W 1 - river here 150 Yds wide smooth rocky shores Small Firs, a small river in this last reach the Inds sometimes go up on the N side - also a Creek on opposite side - enter a narrow Lake WSW ½ - NWbN ½ , Too oot aw ney river falls in here on the Left - comes out of a Lake of the Same Name about SbW 50 miles NbE 2 - NEbN 3 - NbE 1 - NNW 1 not more than 20 Yds wide - a rapid - & small river falls in on the right at the Head of it -

June 23rd NW ¼ a strong rapid, carrying place on the South Side, rather Swampy, tho' we lowered down the Canoe & did not Carry – WNW ¼ – WSW ¼ strong current – Enter another small Lake nearly 1 mile wide, go along it WNW ¼ – NbE 2 – NNE 1 – NNW ¼ – WbN ¼ – a ripple of 200 yds good WNW ¼ – N ¼ – WNW ¼ a rapid – NbE ½ – WNW ½ & go thro a small Sandy Lake – ⅓ mile WNW ½ – and down the river N ⅛ – WNW ¾ this last Course a Continued Rapid put up at 7 Pm – Plenty of Fieldstone Here, the first I have observed.

24th Wednesday At 4 Am Embarked & went down the river W ¼ – WSW ¼ all a continued rapid – SW ⅛ – NWbN ¼ – WNW ¼ & entered a Crooked Lake the way to the left is the Jepowyan road to the athapescow Lake, by a Chain of Small Lakes & Creeks, and is much less dangerous, than the way we are going – but a great deal more Carrying – SW 1 & keep to the right & go WNW ½ – NWbN ½ – NNE 2 a narrow 100 yds wide SWbS ¾ WbS ¼ – NNW ⅛ – W ⅛ – N ¼ – NW ¼ a Bad rapid, however we ran down the upper end of it & lowered down the Lower – called Red Stone rapid, the Bank on the N side being pretty steep & covered with red Stones – SWbW ¾ – SSW 1 – SWbS 1 – SWbW 1 two branches keep the left as being Deeper – near SWbW 1 ½ all a continued rapid but pretty good water – the upper End rather rough water – W ½ across a small round Lake – NbE ¼ – W ¼ – the other Branch falls in again here – SW ¼ – W 1/16 – SSW ⅛ – WSW ⅛ – WNW ⅛ – Iron Stone on N side – SW ⅛ – W ¼ – SWbW ¾ – SSW ¼ – WbN ½ – NW ½ – WNW ½ these 14 Courses river not above 20 yds wide & a continued Series of Rapids & strong current – Entered a Small Lake from 1 to 3 miles wide, NNW 1 – WbS ¾ .



1807

June The Indians Killed a Black Bear while I was taking the Observation, which we Skinned, as it was yet tolerably good – SW 1 ¼ – SWbS ¾ – SWbS ½ a narrow Current & entered another small Lake from 1 to 4 miles wide went along it NNW ¾ – SWbW 1, & went down the river SW ½ SWbW ½ a Strong bad rapid with Perpendicular freestone rocks on both sides called by us Davids Falls – a Portage on the North side to avoid it about 500 Yards – SE ⅛ – SSW ½ strong rapidy current – & ent^{d} a little Lake 3 mile wide – SW ¾ – narrow again WbS ¼ – WbN ¼ – SW ¼ – WNW ⅛ a Trout creek falls in on the left with a rapid at the mouth of it – WNW ⅛ – near N ½ all a strong rapidy current – NNW ⅛ – W ⅛ & Carried on N Side 440 Yds good – the Long way of the Portage is about 670 Crosst the river to W side & Keept down close along the steep rocks NW ½ & came to the Manneto Fall & carried on S side 110 Yards good – this fall is about 15 feet & divides into two, one half running underground about 30 Yards – a most Tremendous fall – Went down the river a strong rapidy current W ¼ – WSW ½ – SSW ¼ a Small Lake went thro it NWbW ¾ – near NW ½ – another smaller Lake NNW ½ – WNW ½ a rapid 50 Yds Long – W ½ – NNW ½ – SSW 1 – a Shoal Bad Rapid – SW 1 – SWbS 1 a Creek N S – & entered a small Lake SW 1 ½ & put up at 7 ½ Pm. – these 5 last reaches river from 2 to 300 Yds wide easy current, Sandy bottom, low grassy Sides – with Several small Grass Is^{d}s on every one of which we found Nests of Swans Eggs – also shot several of them. In the Morning broke the Glass of My Compass – & in the evening Made another out of a Looking Glass & fixed in –

25th Thursday – Cloudy weather & cold, cannot get a Meridian Altitd At 4 ½ Am got underway – SWbW 1 ¼ – NW 1 a ripple 80 Yds Long – WbS 3 easy current & small grassy Ids – SSW ½ – SSW 1 the Brink Rapid – all a continued strong rapid – SSW ¾ Strong current – WSW 2 150 Yds wide & came to a very bad rapid called Brassey's

June Fall – went down it SW ½ – SSE ¼ the lower end very full of large high stones There is a Portage on the South Side about 900 Yards long, indifferent – at the foot of the Rapid on the right hand side the Tearch River falls in, that comes from a pretty sizeable Lake about 30 miles off – pretty deep water in the river & a strong rapid at its mouth – now enter a Small Lake about ½ mile wide & go thro it SWbS ½ – SW ¾ – SW 2 ½ – SWbW 2 – WSW 1 – WSW ½ – SWbW 1 ½ a narrow 60 Yards wide with 2 ripples WSW ½ & entered a small Small Lake as the last about ½ mile wide – WSW 2 & came to a narrow & went along it W ¼ – WSW ⅓ – 20 Yards wide, strong ripples & stony – The Trout River falls in here from the SSE on the Left side – pretty large with a rapid at its entrance – & enter a Small Lake from ½ to ¾ mile wide – go along it from Point to Point WSW ¾ – WSW ¾ – WSW ¾ – WSW ½ – SWbW 1 ½ – SW 1 ½ – W 1 ½ – N 1 & came to a Bad Rapid, led down the head of it & ran down the remainder N ¾ – N ½ strong current – & entered a Lake 1 mile wide in places, went NEbN 1 ¼ & put up at 8 ½ Pm – Much rain in the Day lay by 6 Hours. – Killed several Swans & our Guide burst his Gun in firing at them.

26th Friday A little rain in the Night – at 4 ½ AM got underway & went in the Same Lake as last night NE 2 – NEbN 1 – NEbE 2 – EbS 1 – NEbE ½ – N 2 – N 2 – NEbE 2 here not above 200 yds wide, entire sandy shores. – NEbE ½ – NEbE ½ – NEbE ¾ – NNW ½ – N ½ – NE ¼ & came to a Bad Rapid went down it NNE 1 – then across a small Lake ¼ mile wide NNW ½ – now down the river not more than 40 yds wide NE ¼ – NEbE ¼ – NNW ¼ – NE ½ – W ¼ – NW ¼ – NE ¼ – NE ½ these 4 last reaches a continued shoal strong Bad Rapid – the other 4 above strong current with some small rapids – Here I made the following Lunar Observations; the Latitude of this Spot by the Dead Reckoning is 59°..9 ½' deduced from the Meridian Altitude taken this Day 1 ¾ miles lower down:

1807

June 25th

				☉ ☽ Nearest						☉ ☽ Nearest	
67	21	17	30	105	7	0	21	39	59	104	56	0
		18	34		6	15		41	7		55	30
		19	28		5	45		41	47		55	0
		20	15		5	30		42	35		54	45
		21	34		5	0		43	26		54	15
		22	24		4	15		44	13		54	0
		23	16		4	0		44	55		53	45
		24	3		3	45		45	41		53	15
		25	18		3	15		46	25		52	45
		26	11		2	30		47	10		52	30
	21	21	51	105	4	43	21	43	45	104	54	10
	+		7	—		15	+		7	—		15
	21	21	58	105	4	28	21	43	52	104	53	55

104° 26′ 2″ 104° 40′

				☉ Alt						☉ Altitudes	
				☉ ☽						☉ ☽	
	21	32	30	91	12	15	21	35	20	92	49	30
		33	34		25	30		36	6		58	45
		34	30		36	30		36	55	93	8	15
	21	33	31	91	24	45	21	36	7	92	58	50
	+		8	—		15	+		7	—		15
	21	33	39	91	24	30	21	36	14	92	58	35

Mean 104° 33′ 4″

Went from where the above observations were taken – N ¼ – NEbN ½ a small Lake near ⅓ mile wide with many willow & sand Islands – & high steep sand banks on the right – NWbN 1 – The Porcupine river falls in here on the right in a Small Bay – comes out of a Large Lake in the Northern Indian Country – called Hoon, chang too ah – the river is not passable even with Small Canoes, altho a deal of water, owing to the multitude of Rapids – overhanging Rocks – & in 3 or 4 places it buries itself underground some distance – Such is the Indian account. very sandy at the rivers mouth

☉ D Mer alt ☉ ☽ 107° 55′ 30″
— 15
Lat 59° 11′ 0″ 107° 55′ 15″

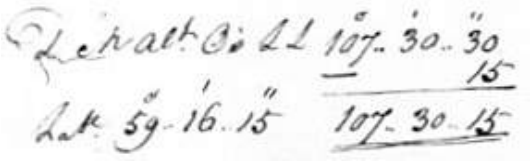
Strong gale ahead lay by here from 11 ½ until 4 then proceeded down the River from ½ to 1 ½ mile wide easy current – W ¾ – WSW ¼ – A narrow 100 yds wide – WSW 1 – here the Stony Mountains nearly join the river & run NEbE into the Northern Indian Country – they are composed of a hard

June grey solid Rock, with some bits like white Flint – their altitude is at least 450 feet above their base – this base is not 2 miles broad – a few small stunted pines growing on it in places – went along the narrow 100 yds wide SW ¾ – SEbS ½ – SSW 1 – WSW ½ a strong shoot of current – NW ⅛ & carried on the North Side 700 yards over very high rough rocks, a Bad Portage into the Black Lake & put up at 9 ½ Pm – a very steep Fall here of 19 feet & has afterwards a decent of 5 feet more, before it falls into the Black Lake.

27th Saturday – as several Long Portages are just beyond this Lake we laid up on a Small Island, until our return back 1 bag of Pimmician – 10 lb Shott 10 lb Gunpowder – 8 lb Sugar, 5 lb Ball, a few Flints – ½ lb Tobacco, & part of the mens things – as it will be only a few days before we expect to return here again – at 5 am Embarked & went in the Black Lake – WbN ½ – WbS ¼ here the Lake opens wide about 6 or 7 Miles, very mountainous on all sides – SW 1 ½ – SW 2 – SWbW ½ W 4 a river called by the Jepowyans on N side of the Lake bears from here NWbN Thay-chel-lay-cothe-ketha falls out of the Hoon chang Lake the same as the Porcupine river does but is very full of Bad rapids – SWbW 1 – SWbN 1 ½ leave the South side & go WSW ½ S 1 ¼ to the Fir Island – WSW ½ – WSW 4 – NWbN ¾ & came to the head of the river & Long Portage – The Black Lake continues near South about 30 miles farther where a river falls in, the Inds Pass this from the Isle a la Crosse – This Lake a very good place for fishing – but very small scrubby wood, a rocky Country, & scarcely any grass to be seen – carried over the Long Portage on the South side the river NWbN 5700 yards, very good level road except about 1 mile at the lower end which is much incumbered with wind fall and very stony – put up at the Lower end of the Portage at 10 Pm – Sand flies very troublesome – This Portage I believe might be shortened much by making 3 or 4 Portages of 100 or 200 yds each, where the steep falls are.

June 28th Sunday – at 5 am got underway. a very thick fogg – WNW 1 – NbW 2, thro a small Lake 2 miles wide – & carried 2000 yards on the left hand side, there are 2 steep hills to carry over – much wind fall wood on it in places, also a little wet – The Fall at this Portage is 28 feet perpendicular in 25 Yards – went SWbW ⅕ & carried on the same side 800 yards – wind fall wood & rather wet in a few places – thicketty of small pines. – The fall at this Portage is most Tremendous, falling 47 feet in 150 Yards distance – SW across the Portage – went down the river WSW ¼ – NW ¼ – N ¼ – SW ½ & entered a small Lake from 300 yds to 1 mile wide – SWbS ¾ a small river & creek falls in here on the right – SWbW 2 – W ½ – WbN 2 ½ – WSW ¼ . a strong rapid shot down it close on our left – altho the Portage is on the other side about 700 yds – course down the rapid SSE ½ – WSW ¾ strong rapidy current SEbS 2 – SW 1 – WSW ½ – WbS 1 a small bay here we put up at 5 ¾ Pm on N Side – the entrance of the Athapescow Lake is WSW 1 ¼ mile distant. this small bay is the same spot we put up at in August 1791. – Easy current since we passed the rapid, about 300 yds wide, low willow sides. – This way we have now come is very short in comparison by passing the Isle a la Crosse & Methy Portage – but the water is much shoaler –

29th Monday –



A thick smoaky air these days past, could not observe for the Longde but in Augt 1791 – I had several Observations here, which determines this Place to be in Longde 105°.32' – pitched our Canoe, ready to return back the same way we have come to the lower end of Deer River – except we pass thro' the Deer Lake – The water has fallen here above 6 feet perpendicular since last Summer – when it was so remarkably high. –

June 30th Tuesday At 2#.57' Am got underway in our return to Deer Lake ¾ of an hour after we Killed a Moose. which detained us till 7 oClock put up on the lower end of the Long Carrying place at 6#.5' Pm – the Sandflies very numerous.
July 1st Wednesday The Sandflies so very numerous that we did not begin to carry until 10 oClock – & we suffered very severely by them – none of us ever saw any thing comparable to them & the 2 Indians declared that they had before experienced the like or near it – got all over at 7 Pm – & paddled out to a Small Island on the Black Lake where we put up – & where thank God we began again to breath –
2nd Thursday – Heavy Thunder & rain in the Night, & inclinable to Rain this morning that it was 8 ½ am before we embarked – about 6 miles on this side the upper end of the Black Lake where we had laid up our Property, we unexpectedly met 2 Canadians in a Small Canoe – & 2 Jepowyans in another, who had followed us expecting we were going to build a House – We asked them if they had seen our things Laid up, which they said they had – but had not meddled with it – we parted they are going to remain at the Athapescow House all Summer – but on our arrival at our Cache found they had Stolen all the Powder, Shott & Sugar – a part of the Ball & Flints 2 Knives & all the Tobacco, & exposed the remainder of the Property to the weather – what rascals these canadians are – what a great pity we had caught them in the act. – put up about 4 miles Short of the Porcupine River at 5#.32' Pm – Lay by a considerable time for rain
3rd Friday – Cold Cloudy & drissling rain Embarked at 4 ½ . got to the Rapid at 5#.25' – got to the North Rapid at 1#.15' – arrived at Brasseys

1807

July Fall at & handed up it & put up about 1 mile above it at 8#.35' Pm Killed several Swans in the Course of the Day. they cannot now fly being molting.
4th Saturday – at 6#.35' AM got underway & got over the Brink rapid at 8#.20' & arrived at the Manneto Lake at 3#.15' Pm – put up at 7#.10' at the Head of Davids fall – handed it up – the other rapids in general we polled up. –
5th Sunday – At 7#.35' AM Embarked & came to the Red Bank rapid at 12#.10' & put up at the Long rapid for rain in the same spot we slept at our first Night down this River. – Stopped at 3 Pm – heavy rain 3 Hours before we stopped
6th Monday – Rain all night & till 4 Pm, with strong wind at N W – & cold weather these 4 Days past. – at 4#.20' Pm embarked & put up a little above the Mouth of Too oot aw ney River at 8#.35.' – very cold weather – 1 Swan.
7th Tuesday – At 3#.50' AM got underway – Left the upper portage at 12#.20' a little above it met several Canoes of Jepowyans, who are going to winter near the Athapescow Lake – put up in the Hatchet Lake at 5 Pm – many more Jepowyans here going the same road – much rain in the Day which detained us much. –
8th Wednesday – Jay ell la our Guide remains here with his countrymen as he cannot get one of them to accompany him to the Deers Lake House for the Payment promised him – gave him a Note of every Article to receive it at any of our Settlements he first visits – the Young Man still continues with us who embarked at the House – in Leading the Canoe over the shoal rapid into Lake Wollaston, every one being out of the Canoe to lighten her – I slipped down between two high stones. tore one of my toe nails out by the root & bruised my foot very much which did not get thoroughly well 4 Months after. – Took up the Skins we Traded on our outward bound Journey – also saw 2 Tents more of Jepowyans from whom we got 21 MB – put up where the Observation for Longde was taken – ⊙ set N62°West. – Embarked at 6 ½ & put up at 9#.50'

1807

July 9th Thursday Lay by all Day, too much Wind – Cloudy weather – my foot very painful no Sleep in the Night

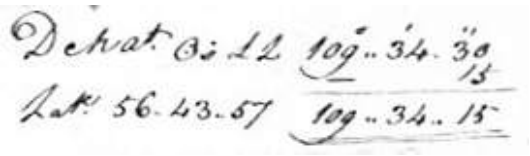
10th Friday – Took an Observation for Latitude & 6 for Longitude which are mentioned before. In the Evening the Wind rather faired & at 5#.10' we Embarked & put up about 15 miles short of the Height of Land at 10#.7.' – Passed by at the Ice Island several Tents of Jepowyans, they have neither meat or Skins – 3 of their Young Men several Days back went with what few furs they had to the Deer Lake House & are expected back daily.

11th Saturday – at 3#.55' Am got underway & got out of Lake Wollaston to the first portage at 6#.45' – here we met the Jepowyans who was expected & had been at the House – at 7 Pm we put up at the edge of the Canoe Rivulet, having carried over all the Portages between the Small Lakes – a very warm Day – and the Men much fatigued in carrying so much. for myself I was obliged occasionally to be assisted over, owing to my bad foot. – Got an observation for Latd as mentioned before

12th Sunday – Embarked at 3#.55' Am & arrived at the Lower carrying place in the Creek at 10#.50' where I got an Observation for Latitude. – put up at the Entrance of Deers Lake at 5#.2' Pm – Killed a Young Deer water risen several Inches here since we passed – Led down the Canoe at all the Rapids we carried at going out. in Canoe Rivulet.

13th Monday – our Young Indian, intends us to go thro' the Deer Lake, he has only seen the road a few times, he says it is very difficult owing to the innumerable Islands & Deep bays – at 6 ½ Am left the Mouth of Canoe Rivulet & went back our old track until we came to the South end of the Narrow Mentioned 15th June – we now alter our course to the Left & go along the West Shore of the Deers Lake from Point to Point or Island as follows

July NEbE 3 ¼ – NEbN ½ – NEbE 1 – NNE 1 – NNE ½ & went thro a narrow ESE ½ formed by two large Islands – here Mr Malchom Ross built in the fall 1796 – Called Bedford House – and owing to the lateness of the following Spring it was the 5 July before he left his House – Even then the Ice had only melted away along the Shores. – EbS 1 ¼ – ESE ¾ – ESE ¼ – ESE 3. the Southern Branch of the Paint river falls in here on the right hand. – S ½ 4 – SbE 2 ½ SbE 1 ½ – SbE 2 ¼ – SSE 1 no land in sight to the Eastward nearly all the way except a few Is^{d}s which is the case all along the Lake we are going, till we fall into our old Track going up the Bay. – S ½ – NbE ¾ – ENE ½ – SE ½ – SSE 2 – SbW 2 – S ½ – SWbS 3 – E 3 – SEbS ¼ – SbE ¾ – SEbE 2 – SE 1 – SEbS 2 – SEbS ¼ – SEbS 1 ½ – SEbS 1 – SSE 1 – SSE 1 & put up at 8.20 Pm.
14th Tuesday – at 3$^{\#}$.47' Am Embarked & went SSE 4 & came to a very narrow place – between steep rocks – SSE 1 ½ – SbE ½ – a great number of Indian tent places here in a small sandy bay on our left: E ¼ – E ½ – E ¼ – SSE ¾ – SbE 2 – SbW 2 – S 1 ½ – S 2 – SbE 1 ½ – SSE 2 – SbE ½ – SSW 3 – SW ¾ – SWbW 1 –



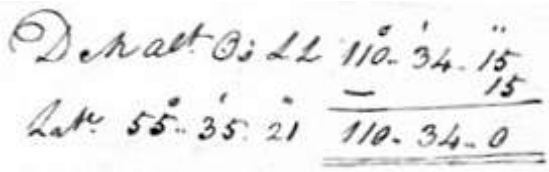
Continued on as before along the Deers Lake SSW ¾ – SbW 2 – SbW ¼ – W ½ a very narrow place, & good for fishing. WbS ½ – SWbS 1 – SbW 2 ½ – S 1 – SSW 1 – SSW 1 ½ – SSW ¾ – SSW 2 – SSW 2 – SbE ¾ – SbE ¼ – SSW 2 – SSW 2 ½ – SSW ½ & entered a narrow formed by large Island, 100 yds wide SWbW ½ – SWbW 1 & put up at 7 ½ Pm. –
15th Wednesday – at 3$^{\#}$.15' Am got underway went along a kind of narrows – SWbS 1 – WSW 1 – SW 1 – SSW 1 – SSW 1 – SWbS 1 ¼ – SSW ½ and fell into our old Track we passed 12th June arrived at the Deers Lake House at 5$^{\#}$.5' Am – very deep clear water in the Deers Lake with rocky mountainous Land – plenty of good Fish & Deer. – our Pilot who left us in Lake Wollaston arrived here 5 Days after we parted – the Canadian Master here La Rock had given him a very severe drubbing & had even broke two of his ribs, on account of his Piloting us along –

July 16th Thursday – Packed up 150 MB traded by us in our Journey, & at the House since the Boats went down in the Spring – in view of their being sent to England this year – Paid the Young Jepowyan, for assisting carrying the Canoe & Piloting us thro this Lake 10 MB in various goods – John Wishart accompanies us as pilot down to Nelson House – At 10#.50' Am left the House & came to the first Portage at 12#.20' – left it at 12#.45' – arrived at the 2nd Portage at 1#.35' & left it at 2#.0' – got to the Strong Rapid at 3#.7' & put up 3 miles short of the Mountain Portage at 8#.15'

17th Friday Embarked at 3#.55' Am – got to the Mountain Portage at 4#.35' left it at 5#.40' – arrived at the Bottom of Deer River at 4 ¾ Pm – and proceed down the Missinnippi or Churchill river as below – ESE 1 only 60 Yards wide, a strong rapid – & enter a small Lake 3 miles wide, in which Mr Malchom Ross built Fairford House about 1795 – a small River falls in from the Southward – comes out of Dickins's Lake about 4 or 5 miles off up the River – ENE ¾ – NEbE ¾ a small rapid & narrow – NEbN 1 – ENE ½ – NE ½ – EbN ½ & carried over a small Pine Island 10 Yards – good – EbS ¾ – NE ½ in which are Fletts 2 Rapids, strong & Bad. NEbN ¼ a small rapid – EbN ¼ – SSE ¼ – SSW ¾ a ripple – & enter a small Lake ESE ¼ – EbN ½ – ESE ¼ . a narrow NNE ¾ then down ½ mile wide ENE 1/16 & carried over the Muddy Portage on the N side into a Bay 910 Yards – wet & swampy at the Lower end – put up here 8#.10' Pm.

18th Saturday – at 4#.33' Am got underway – proceed down Churchill River as before – NNE 1 – SE ½ – SEbS ½ & came to the mouth of the river on our right hand SEbS ½ – SSE ½ & ran down Chambers Rapid on the North side, strong – about 40 Yds long – EbS ½ a strong shoot of current – N 1 – & entered the Stony Lake about 3 ½ miles wide where De plaws House was when he Stole the Skins from the Churchill people – went thro

July – it NEbE 2 – a narrow – SE ½ & ran down the back rapid on the North side – strong – 70 yards long – SE ¼ – ESE ¼ – a ripple – NbW ¾ – ESE ½ in which are the Devils Lower rapid – the two upper ones are 40 & 30 yards long respectively and tolerable, carried at the 2nd one 20 yds over a rocky point on the right & just below is a tremendous fall – where we carried on the same side 50 Yards – ESE ¼ a ripple – NEbN ½ a ripple on N side an Island. – NbE ¼ ENE ⅛ – & ran down a rapid 100 yards long on the N side, bad eddy current below it – SSE ¼ – ENE ¼ – ESE ¾ and entered a small Lake about 6 miles long & 1 ½ wide, went along it NE ¼ – E ⅛ – ESE ¼ – SSE ½ – SSE ¾ – SEbS ½ – & entered a narrow NbE ½ – NbE ¾ – here the river divides into two branches we keep the right as being according to our Guides account the best – went down it NEbE ⅛ – EbS ⅛ & carried on N side close along shore 50 yards, passed a strong fall – EbS ⅛ , a deep bay on our right where Halcro Smith conducted Mr McNab fall 1801 into & declared he could not find the way farther from whence they returned back with the 2 Boats. – Halcro was under a secret engagement with the Canadians never to go higher up the Country than the Entrance of Deers River. – NbW 1 here the other branch joins & forms a Small Lake – EbS ¼ – ESE ⅛ – NNE ½ – N ¼ – NE ½ – NNE ⅛ . SE ⅛ .



S ⅛ very narrow & entered a Small Lake – NEbE 1 ¼ – a narrow & go along the NE side the Latter Lake about 2 miles wide – SSE 1 ¼ & entered a narrow from 100 to 200 yds wide with a little current in it – SE 1 – SbE 2 – SbW 1 & entered a small Lake 1 ½ Long & ¾ wide – went along it SEbS ¾ & carried over the Governors Portage 290 yards on the N side into a small bay – good camping place – except about 30 yds lower end steep. – down the bay ESE ¼ & ran down a Crooked Rapid NNE ¼ – ESE ½ – SEbS ½

July – S ½ in which is a rapid ½ mile Long, but good going down – EbE ½ – EbS ½ – NEbE ½ a large opening on the right – falls in again below the Island Portage. – NE ¼ – NNE ¼ – ENE ¼ & carried over the Sturgeon Portage 430 yards on the North side – good road – & cross a small Lake NbE 1 – N ½ a ripple – ENE ¼ – N ½ these 2 last courses strong current & enter another small Lake cross it ENE ¾ – ENE ¼ – a branch strikes off on our right which joins again just below the Island Portage – NNW ½ – NNE ¼ strong current & one ripple – NbW ¼ – NNW ¼ & carried over the Island Portage 90 yards. a perpendicular fall of 15 feet – it requires great care in coming down to it as the Current is strong – & the high fall on both sides the Island. – NW ¼ – NE ½ – NNE ½ – NEbE 1 (in this reach the branch above Sturgeon portage falls in) – carried on South over 100 Yards. very good road – a very heavy fall, with high perpendicular rocks on each side – put up here at 5#.20' Pm – the water has fallen here 7 feet since last Summer.

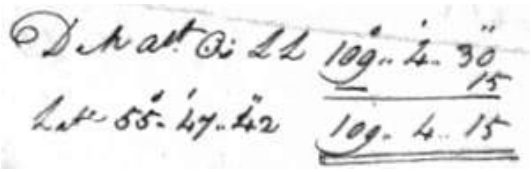
19th Sunday – at 3#.25' Am embarked – went NE ¾ a strong eddy current all the way – N ¼ – & ESE ¼ across the N end of the Sturgeon Lake about 3 miles Long – thro a narrow NEbN ¼ – NWbN ¼ all strong current – NE ¼ a small Lake went along it ENE 1; River NE ½ a noted place for the Indians in the Spring spearing Sturgeon – NNE ¼ a strong shoot current & strong bad whirling Eddies – & enter the Doctors Lake about 1 Mile wide, went thro it NbE 1 – NbE 2 a narrow 300 yds wide – NNW 1 – NW ¾ – NNE ⅛ NNW ¼ here the river is only 20 yards wide very strong current & very violent, bad whirling Eddies. being very dangerous NEbE ½ – NNW ¼ a ripple on the North side an Island – NE ¼ & entered a Lake. kept along the right hand side as we intend calling to see

1807

July Mr William Tomison at Duck Lake – NEbN 1 ½ & landed in a fine sandy bay at the West end of the Duck Portage – carried over it E 1520 yards into a small narrow grassy bay of the Duck Lake – the Portage is pretty good – went along the Duck Lake E 1 ½ – EbN ¼ Lake opens – NE 1 ½ – ENE 1 ¼ – & carried 10 yards over a very narrow neck joining formerly 2 Islands – now only one – where Mr Malchom Ross built about 1794 or 5. – NE ¼ & came to Mr Tomisons House built by him last fall – arrived at 10 am – he is very badly with a sore hand. – no fish to be caught here now at this Season of the Year. –

20th Monday – At 3 Pm we embarked & left the House – carried over the Duck portage and put up, & pitched the Canoe ready to proceed early tomorrow morning – for Nelson House, which we expect to reach in 2 Days.

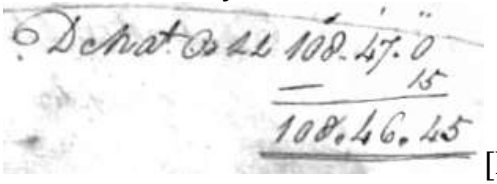
21st Tuesday – At 3#.45' Am got underway from the West end of the Duck Portage & go down Churchill River – N 1 ½ – NbE 1 a narrow, go along it NbE ½ – NbE ½ – NNE ¾ – N ½ – NbW ½ – N ¼ & entered the Loon Lake from 1 to 4 miles wide – NNE 2 ½ – NNE ½ – NbE ¼ – N 1 – NNE ¼ NNE 1 – NEbN ¾ on the SW side opposite here the Loon river falls in – & a little more to the Southward another small river – a House built here by Mr Wm Linklatter. – ENE 2. a branch goes off on the right – which joins again just below the Loon Fall. – NEbE 2 narrow 50 yds wide & strong current – NE ½ – a strong shoot current 100 yards – & rather wider – ESE ¼ – SE ½ – Loon fall carrying place on N side 40 yds but we ran it down – E ¼ very strong bad whirling eddies – the branch mentioned a little above falls in here with a strong rapid at the mouth NE ½ – EbS 1 – SE ¾ – and entered a pretty Large Lake, went along it SE 1 – ESE 1 – SEbS 1 – ESE 1 – EbS 1.



1807

July – the observation taken on the N end of a small Island – continue along the same Lake SEbE 1 ½ – SE1 & enter a narrow 300 yds wide – the lake extends a long way towards the SSW. – down the narrow NNE ½ – NE ¾ – E ¼ & carried at the Bloodstone fall on the right hand side 150 yards good road – a very strong fall – NEbE ¾ – NbE ¼ – NEbE ½ – E ½ & entered the Moose Lake about 1 ½ mile wide, went along it EbN ¼ – EbN 2 ½ – & entered a narrow 50 yds wide – NbE ½ – NNE ¾ – NbE ½ – N ¼ a rapid at an Is^{d}. the North side is the best water – NE ½ – EbN ½ & entered Pock kat twaw gan Lake – ESE ½ – EbN ¼ – SE1 – SEbS 1 ¼ – SEbS ½ – SEbS ½ – SEbS ¼ – S ½ . Pock at twaw gan House on the left. – EbSE 2 – EbS ½ S 1 – E ½ – EbS ½ – SEbE ¼ – E ¼ – E ¾ – E ½ – & carried over an Island 50 yards. rocky. good – this last Lake 4 miles wide in places – put up on the Carrying place at 7#.12'.

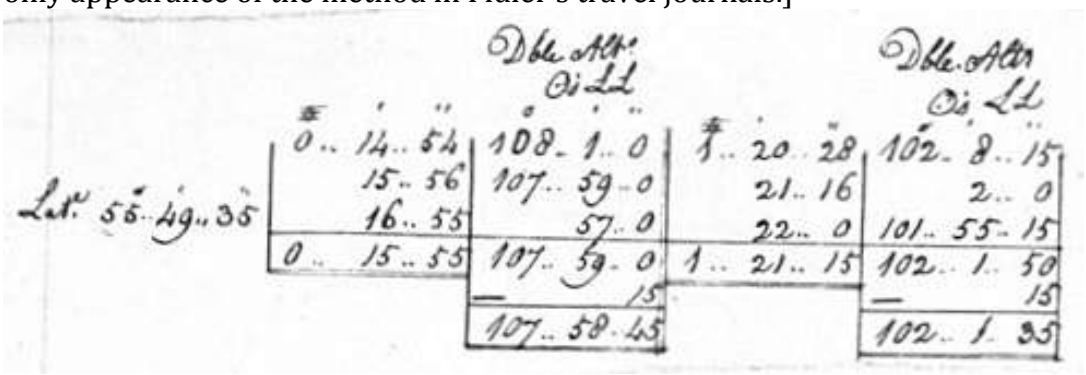
22nd Wednesday – At 3#.32' Am got underway went SEbE ½ strong rapidy current & entered a pretty Large Lake – from 2 to 6 miles wide – ENE ½ – NEbS 2 ½ – EbN ½ – SE ¼ – EbN ¼ – NEbE 1 ¼ – EbN ½ – ENE ¾ – NE 1 – ESE ¾ – E ¼ – EbN ½ – & entered a narrow 200 yards wide – ENE ½ – E ½ – NE ½ – NNE ½ – the Three Tracks or Nees to y aws on the Right, goes to Nelson River. opens ESE –- NbW ½ – NNE ¼ – ENE ¾ – EbS ½ – & entered a Lake from ¾ to 5 or 6 miles wide – SEbE ¼ – ENE ¾ – NE ¼ – NEbN ¾ – Shaving point on the right – NE 1 ½ – NEbN 1 ½ a narrow NE 1 then opens again – NEbN ½ – NEbN ¼ – NEbN ¼ – NE ¼ – NEbE 1 – NEbE ½ – ENE ¼ – ENE 1 an Island our people call half way from the Neestoyaws to Nelson House ENE 1 ¾



[lat 55°44'22"]

July taken on the South end of a Large Island. – EbN 1 ½ – E ¾ – EbN 2 ½ – NEbE ½ – N 1 ½ – NbW 1 ¼ – NE 2 ½ & entered a narrow 150 yds wide, went along it NE 1 & arrived at Nelson House at 4#.3' Pm –

23rd Thursday – at Noon the Sky was cloudy – but a little after it cleared up when I took the following Double altitudes to ascertain the Latitude. [Latitude by 2 non-meridian altitudes used here was only published in English in 1759 (it was included in Maskelyne's British Mariner's Guide of 1763). This is the only appearance of the method in Fidler's travel journals.]



	Dble Alt. ☉ ⊥		Dble. Alt. ☉ ⊥	
	° ′ ″	° ′ ″	° ′ ″	° ′ ″
Lat. 55.49.35	0.. 14.. 54	108.. 1.. 0	1.. 20.. 28	102.. 8.. 15
	15.. 56	107.. 59.. 0	21.. 16	2.. 0
	16.. 55	57.. 0	22.. 0	101.. 55.. 15
	0.. 15.. 55	107.. 59.. 0	1.. 21.. 15	102.. 1.. 50
		— 15		— 15
		107.. 58.. 45		102.. 1.. 35

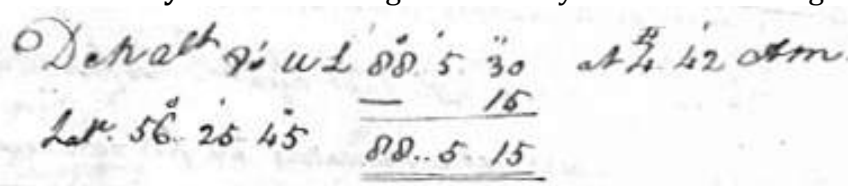
Delivered to the Master here the 2 Large Bundles of Furrs we brought from the Deers Lake House – as he expects in 4 or 5 Days 2 Boats up from the Factory which is to unload here & return down again for a Second trip. – Very heavy Thunder & rain all last night – John Wishart who Piloted us down here from the Deers Lake remains as he does not know the road below. – Henry Garrock goes in his place – altho he is a little doubtful of some places. –

24th Friday – At 6#.20' Am Embarked and left Nelson House, & went back thro the narrow SW 1 & entered Nelson Lake again – went down it WbN ½ – NWbN 1 – NNW ¾ – NNW ½ – NNW 1 – NNW ½ – NNW 2 – NNW ¼ – NNW 1 – NNW 1 ½ – NW ¼ – NWbW ¼ – W 2 & carried 160 Yards on the South side good road – a very heavy fall. – a great swell below it – WSW ¼ – NW ½ & carried 60 Yards on South side, a steep hill to go down – very bad eddies below this fall – SW ⅛ – NbW 2 about 3 mile wide – a Lake 3 miles wide N 1 – NbW 1 ½ NNW 3 a narrow of 100 Yards – & put up at 3 Pm – for Rain –

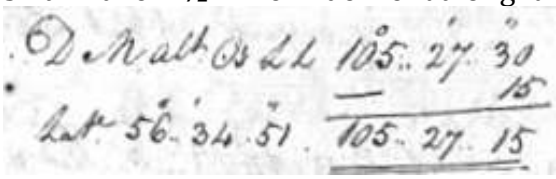
25th Saturday – at 4#.15' Am Embarked & went down NNW 1 ¼ – NNE ½ – NE ¾ – NEbE ½ – EbN ½ only 20 yds wide, a strong shoot of Current & bad whirling eddies below – E 1 – ENE ¼ – NbW ⅛ & carried at Granville Fall on the North side 220 Yards good road – a very steep fall of 11 Feet perpendicular

July – NWbN ¼ – N ¼ – NNE ½ – NNW ¾ – W ½ – WSW ½ – & entered Granville Lake, no Land in sight from SW to NW – NWbN ¾ – NWbN ½ – NWbN 1 WbN 1 – WNW 1 ½ . an Island making a small narrow, where a Canadian House is standing, called ã pis se pin a pen nã kew. – went between the Is^{d} & the Main NEbE ¼ – NNE ¼ & the Lake again opens wide – N 1 ½ – NNE ½ – NEbE 3 – NNE ¼ – NE 1 ½ – NEbE 2 & entered another narrow in the same Lake formed by Islands go along it ENE ¼ – NNE ½ , an Indian Painted Stone on the left hand side – N ¼ – EbN ⅛ – here the Lake opens again – NEbN 1 ¼ & put up at 5#.15' Pm – lay by 6 hours in the Day for the strong wind. & very cold.

26th Sunday – at 3#.22' Am got underway – continued along the Lake ENE ¾ , NNE 1 – NNE ¾ – NbE 1.



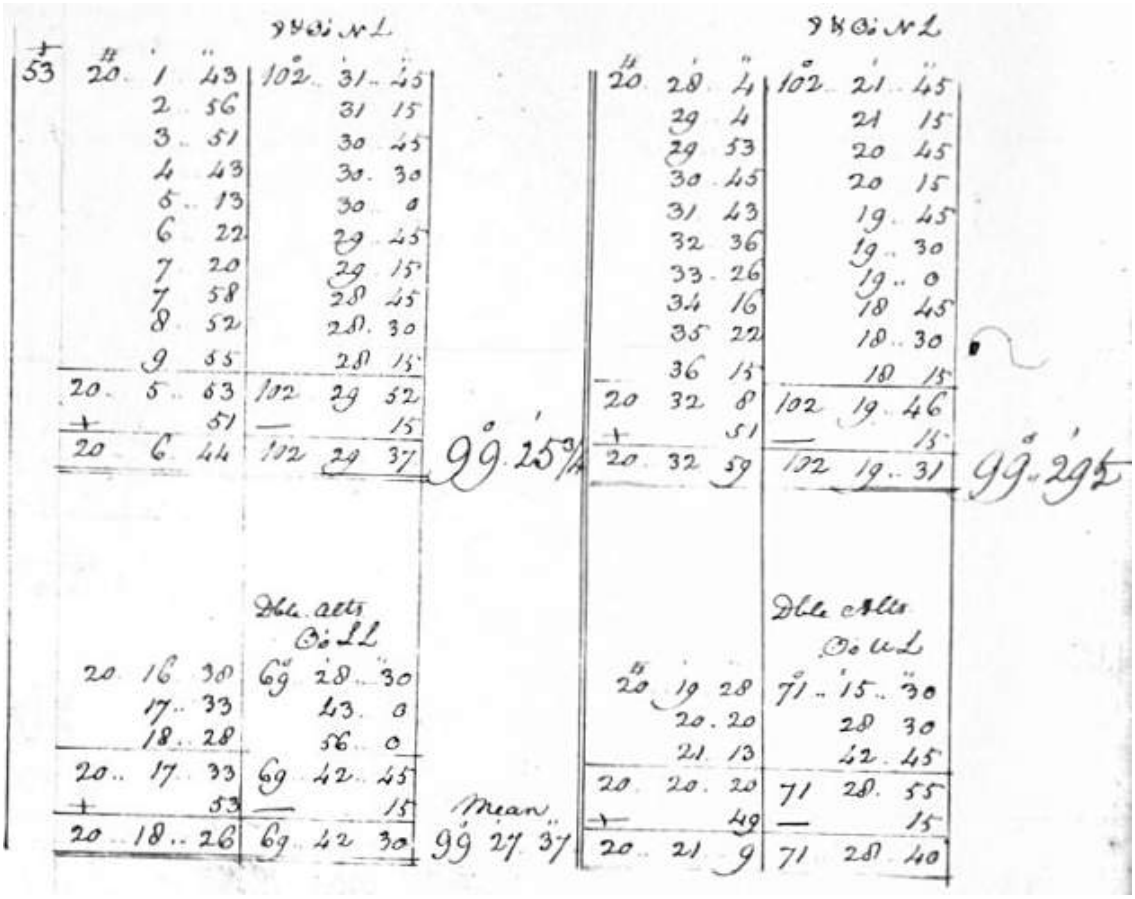
Taken on the SE point of an Island – ENE ¼ – NEbN ¾ – NEbN ¼ – NNE ¾ – NEbN 2 a narrow of 30 yards a strong shoot current & bad eddies – NEbN ¼ – NNE ½ another strong shoot of current – E ½ – NE ½ – E ½ a strong shoot of current & bad eddies below – E ½ & carried over the Weed Portage on the South side 80 yards very level & good – took two sets of Lunar observations here, as on the other side. – went down the river NEbN ½ – NEbN ¾ 200 yds wide – NbW 1 ½ a strong shoot current & entered a small Lake 1 ½ mile wide went along it NEbN 1 ½ – NE 1 – NNE 1 ¼ .



Taken on a small rocky Is^{d} near the middle between both sides - NNE ½ narrow ESE ¼ - & entered another Small Lake 1 ½ mile wide - NNE ¾ – NNE 1 ½ - NE ½ - NbE 1 - NE 1/$ - a narrow - EbN ½ & opens again - NE 1 ½ - NNE 1 - a strong shoot of current 50 Yards wide - & entered the Oo patch e wan now Lake

July – which is 14 or 16 miles wide – went along it NE 1 – NNE ¼ – NNE ½ – NbE 3 – NbW ½ – NbW 2 ½ . an old Canadian House – NE 1 ¼ thro' a narrow, a strong rapid in it & entered the Southern Indian or Big Lake went along it NEbN 2 – NEbN 1 ½ two old Houses here one belonging to the Canadians – this is the lowest place they have had a Settlement at in Churchill River – put up here at 7 Pm –

25th



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53	20	1	43	102	31	45		20	28	4	102	21	45		
		2	56		31	15			29	4		21	15		
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		4	43		30	30			30	45		20	15		
		5	13		30	0			31	43		19	45		
		6	22		29	45			32	36		19	30		
		7	20		29	15			33	26		19	0		
		7	58		28	45			34	16		18	45		
		8	52		28	30			35	22		18	30		
		9	55		28	15			36	15		18	15		
	20	5	63	102	29	52		20	32	8	102	19	46		
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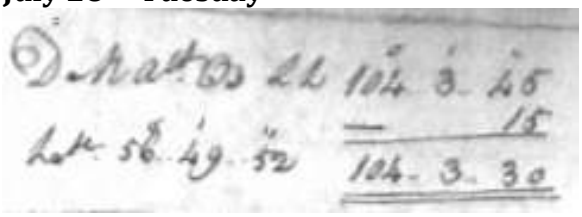
				Dble alts Ob LL							Dble Alts Ob LL				
	20	16	30	69	28	30		20	19	28	71	15	30		
		17	33		43	0			20	20		28	30		
		18	28		56	0			21	13		42	45		
	20	17	33	69	42	45		20	20	20	71	28	55		
	+		53	—		15	Mean	+		49	—		15		
	20	18	26	69	42	30	99° 27′ 37″	20	21	9	71	28	40		

Latitude P[er] Dead Reckoning 56°29 ¾' Variation 8° East.

27th Monday – Embarked at 3#.35' & went along the Big Lake as below – NEbN 1 ½ – NE 1 ½ – NEbE ½ – NEbN 1 – EbN ¼ – we went about 10 Miles farther & got lost. our Guide not knowing the road we therefore after much fruitless search for the right way – returned back to this place as being in the fair way until the Churchill Boats pass which are hourly expected – Set a net as all our Provision is done – & fortunately caught a good number of Fish. –

July 28th Tuesday –



Lay by all day waiting somebody to come to us. – caught a good number of Fish.

29th Wednesday – at 7 ½ Am several Canoes of Jepowyans came to where we are staying – they have lately been down at Churchill Factory. – engaged a Young Man to pilot us out of this Lake which is large, & full of many Islands & Deep bays – afterwards our English Guide thinks he will not go wrong – gave the Indian an Old Belt 1 Horn Powder & 20 Balls – & ¼ yard of Tobacco – & at 5#.32' Am Embarked & proceeded thro' the Southern Indian or Big Lake Called by our People – NE 2 ½ – NEbN 3 – NEbN 2 – NE 2 ½ – ENE 1 – EbN 2 ½ & passed among several small Islands – a little current here – EbN ¼ – EbN ½ – EbN 1 ¼ – NEbE 1 – NEbE 2 ¼ – NE ½ – NNE ¼ – NNE ½ E 2 – a high steep sandy point on the right hand. – NEbN ¾ – NEbN 1 – NNE 1 ¾ a good Place for catching fish with netts here – NEbE 1 ¼ – N ½ E 1 ½ – N ½ E 2 – NbE ½ – NNE ¾ – & put up at 7#.10' Pm –

30th Thursday. Embarked at 3#.57' Am & went along the Big Lake as before NbE ½ – NE ½ – NEbE 3 ½ – NEbE 3 – NE 1 – N ½ & came to the point of the crossing place, a very large opening to the W – N ½ E 2 ½ across the opening to an Island – ENE ¼ – NNE 1 – N ½ E 2 ½ – N 1 – & entered a narrow formed by an Is^d on the left – NbW ½ – NWbN ¼ – N ¾ & came again to the wide open Lake NbW 2 ½ – NbE ¼ – NNE ¾ – EbN 1 – mouth of the river & end of the Big Lake – rocky shores, with Plenty of small Pine &c – Deep clear water – went down the river very strong current NEbE ½ & carried at the Wath then nay cum mow fall on the South side 40 Yards – very rocky & a heavy swell at the bottom – found several Jepowyans here. who has just returned from the Factory – entered a small Lake ¾ wide went along it ENE 2

July – & came to the lower end of another branch, that takes off 5 miles above the Carrying Place – & the head of the river, went down it NbE 1 strong rapidy current here we met Mr Joseph Spence with 2 Boats from Churchill 5 men in each – he gave us 40 lb oatmeal for Provision to put us down to the Factory – our Young Jepowyan Guide also returned back with him. – Received a Letter from Mr Auld – remained together 1 ½ hour – when we separated. – continued down the river ENE ½ a strong rapid on our right, kept the left branch – NNE ¼ – NNW ½ – N ¼ – NE ½ – E ⅛ – SbW ¾ – mouth of the other Branch – ESE ½ – strong rapidy current above – & entered a small Lake EbS 1 ½ – ESE 1 – SEbE 1 – NE ½ – NNE ½ – NNE 1 ¼ – N ½ & entered the river N ⅛ 20 Yards wide & a very strong rapid ran it down, bad whirlpools below – E ½ – NE ½ – ENE ⅛ – N ¾ – NNW ½ N ⅛ generally strong rapidy current – & carried over the Chalk Portage on the right hand side 750 Yards – pretty good road, a very steep hill about 30 Yards long at each end – put up here at 7 ½ Pm. –

31st Friday at 5#.22' Am got underway went down the river strong current ESE ½ – SEbE ½ – NNE ½ here nearly ½ mile wide – NEbE ¾ – E ¼ – SE ¼ – E ⅛ & entered the Northern Indian or Sandy Lake called by our People – went in it NEbE 1 ½ – ENE 1 – EbN 2 ½ – E ½ – ENE 1 – E ½ – EbS 1 – SSE ¾ – SEbE 1 – SEbE ¼ – SE ½ E 3 – a narrow ¼ mile wide – then opens wide – ESE ½ S 3 to the upper end of Big Island – EbN ½ & arrived at one of our Houses two people remaining here – stopped one hour & then embarked & continued along this Lake E ¾ – NE ¾ – NEbN ¾ – NE 1 – ENE 1 ¼ & came to the river, went down it N 1 a strong rapid 70 yds Long, kept close on the left – NNE 1 & met Mr John Charles with 3 Boats at 3 ¾ Pm & put up together – he supplied us with a little Biscuit & Cheese – & offered us any thing we wanted & that he had – cold weather – Indeed this has been the Coldest Summer I have known these 19 Years that I have been in this Country – Very sandy banks in many Places along this last Lake

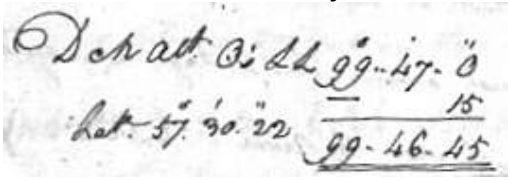
August 1st Saturday - at 5#.2' Am parted company with Mr John Charles & proceeded each his way – entered Small Lake went along it ENE 2 – EbN ¼ – EbN ½ - NEbW 1 & ran down Kuthness Rapid 100 yards long – pretty strong – then turns wider SEbS 3 - SSE 1 – SbE 1 ½ - S 1 ½ very narrow here, but no perceptable current – SEbE ¾ & entered a Lake went along the N side it ESE 2 & entered the river 200 yds wide – NNE 1 – E ¾ - NEbE 1 – NEbE ½ 50 yards wide – NEbN 1 ¼ a small Bay on the left a good place for fishing place – SEbS ½ - NE ⅛ & arrived at the upper end of the Five Portages – At 9#.10' – Carried on the N side, good road 150 yards – SbE ½ & carried on the North side 220, good – a steep hill at the lower end – this fall is the steepest & highest I have yet seen in this river – SSW ⅛ - ESE ½ - E ½ - SE ½ - SSE ¼ - SSE ¼ - EbN ½ the manneto rapid ran it down, but shipped a deal of water a dangerous rapid – EbN ¾ - SSE ¼ - ESE ½ all strong rapidy current - & Carried over the Swampy Portage 870 yards on the South Side, 60 yards wet in three places – a perpendicular fall – ESE ¼ - SSW ⅛ all rapidy – ESE ½ & Carried over the otter Portage a small Hill on the South side 130 yards – pretty good – E 1 river here ½ mile wide & all a strong, shoal rapid – here again only 400 yds wide NEbN ½ a shoal, strong rapid & carried over a grassy place 150 yds good – a Canoe might safely shoot it on the left hand side opposite to where we carried – but as we are one Canoe alone, we carry & hand several places that might be ran down – S ¾ - NEbN 1 ½ near ½ mile wide – ESE ½ Strong current about 200 yds wide – NEbN 2 – ENE 1 – NNE ¾ - ESE ½ a ripple – ESE ½ - NEbE ¾ & put up at 7 ½ Pm –

2nd Sunday . at 4#.5' Am Embarked & went down the river, strong current - 200 yards wide SSE ½ - SEbE ½ - White Musk rat Creek on the left – SEbE ½ - near ESE 3 – NE 1 – E ½ - NE 1 a Pine Pt & small rapid & entered a small Lake 2 ½ miles wide – EbN 2 – EbS 3 . a narrow & go thro a kind of swampy Lake with wet shores & several low willow Islands near ½ mile wide

August N ½ E 3 – N ½ E 2 ½ river here 300 yds wide, with little or no current – NbW 1 – NbE 2 – EbS ¾ - NEbE 1 – NNE ½ these 3 last courses strong current & 2 small rapids – NNW 2 & arrive at the upper end of the Ten Portages at 10#.47' – Carry on the North side 250 good – NNE ½ in which are two strong shoots of current at the lower one Mr Malcholm Ross was unfortunately drowned by falling out of the Head of the Boat fall 1799 – Carry on N side 100 yds. good – ESE ⅓ - & carry on N Side 140 yds – NEbN ⅓ - E ¼ - NEbN ⅓ all a strong rapid ran down them close along the North side – & carry at Field rocks 20 yards on the same side – good – EbS 1 – SE ¼ these two reaches river wider, and smooth current – Carry 260 yds on N side along the face of 3 small hills – pretty good – NE ¼ & carry over the Grave Portage 370 yards very level & good NNE ½ all rapidy current & carry at a small Is^d 50 yards where one Boat was lost at last Year – NNE ¼ & carry over smooth rocks on N side 30 yards just above this portage a very dangerous Eddy – a tremendous fall on the South side the river – ENE ¼ across a small bay & carried 200 yds over a level grassy point – NNE ⅓ & carried over a stony grassy point 90 yards into still water – river here 600 yards wide, steep clay banks – NNE 1 mile & put up at 8#.2' Pm – nearly all one continued heavy fall from beginning to the End of these ten Carrying places except the 2 Courses mentioned above – on the South side – Keep close along the North side from bottom to top –

3rd Monday Embarked at 4#.9' Am & went down Churchill River as before NEbN 2 – 600 yds wide easy Current – NNE 1 300 yds wide – NWbN 1 strong Current – WSW ¼ a strong rapid – WbS a rapid – & asmak river on South side & come to the Head of the FOUR Carrying places – <u>NNW ½ - near N ¾</u> all a strong rapid, the lower end a Portage 100 yds on South Side, but we ran it down – NE ½ a Carrying place on the North side 50 yards, but we ran it down also – NbW ½ - NbW ½ a Portage on the N side 40 yds but ran it also – a

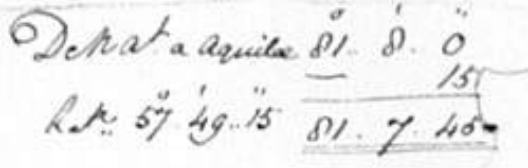
August a small river falls in here on the North side – EbN ¾ - NNE ½ - NEbE ½ - EbS ¼ & carried on the North side 40 yards, good – a very strong rapid with very high breakers – SE ½ - a strong rapid ran down it – ENE 1 ½ strong rapidy current very high & almost perpendicular white clay banks on each side the river nearly 500 feet high – very strong current all the way – ENE 1 – NNE 1 – banks ran down much here with the Woods all standing & almost choaked the river up in 1805 – these slidings down of the Bank is frequent in the low Country near the Sea Coast, by the Surface thawing & the rains insinuating between the froze & unfroze part, which is seldom above 2 or 3 feet deep – all below, for ever frozen. – NEbE ¾ - N NE ½ - River about 200 yards wide but in someplaces not more than 60. – NEbE 1 ½ - SbE ¾ - EbN 1.



Cloudy weather these several Days past. could not get an Observation. – proceed down the river as before – Little Churchill River falls in here on the right hand side opens SbE by a communication with Nelson River – ENE ½ an Old House on the Left – NEbN ½ 700 yards wide – NbE 3 a bay on the left 1 mile deep with an Island in it – NW 1 ¼ this last reach 500 yards wide W 1 – SW ¾ - S ¼ - WSW ¾ - NWbW ¾ - W ½ an Island – very little current since the Observation – WSW ¾ Swallow Rapid nearly 1 mile long & strong. – River 600 yards wide – NbW 4 – 800 yards wide – NW 1 ¼ - about 500 yards wide – with 1 strong short rapid – N 1 ½ a strong short rapid in the reach – NE 1 – N ¾ a rapid in each of the reaches from 200 to 400 Yards long each – NNW ½ - WbN 2 Stone Pt – a rapid – & an Old House on the North side – just below the House on the same side Little Beaver River falls in – & a little lower down a pretty stout Creek – NNE 3 ½ all

1807

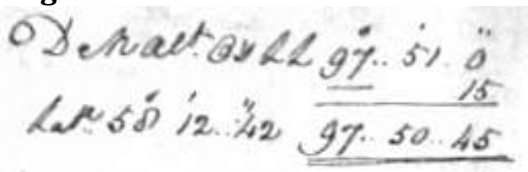
August a continued strong rapid – river 700 yards wide – N 1 ½ all rapidy – ENE ½ the same – the woods here are very small & stunted, with thick moss on the Ground EbS ¾ all a strong rapid as before – river about 400 yards wide – & carried 100 Yards on the South Side, very good – called the Big fall – a steep Limestone bank on opposite side – EbS ½ - ENE ¾ all a strong rapid & very bad, lowered the Canoe down on Poles – a Creek on S side, put up here at 7#.45' Pm – Cold & Clear



4th Tuesday – Cold clear frosty Night – the Ice laying here along the Banks of the River above 30 feet thick drove here, when the river opened in the Summer & in all probability will not be melted away this Season – Embarked at 3#.45' Am – NE 1 ½ all a strong bad rapid – crossed to N side – ESE ¾ - steep overhanging rocks & a bad rapid called the Kiln 100 yds long – very dangerous – NNE ¾ a Steep rocky Point on South Side called Brandy Point & a strong rapid ran it down, rather rough water – the Kiln we lowered down with a Line – & was very near filling the Canoe at it - we took much water in over the Gunwales – River 120 yards wide – NE. 2 – NEbN 3 fine smooth banks here for Tracking – ENE 1 ½ - NEbN 4 – NE ½ - EbN 1 ½ - NE 2 – EbS 1 – NE 1 Red head Rapid on the North side – strong but deep – NbE 1 ¼ all rapidy current – EbN 1 the lower end of which is a strong smooth shoal rapid called the Running Landing place – river 300 yds wide – & the rapid is near ½ mile long – & rather dangerous the current running so very swift over the smooth shoal Limestone Rocky bottom. – ENE 1 ½ - NE 1 all strong rapidy current NEbN ½ a Creek here on each side – banks at the Top bare of woods – NbE ½ at the reach before a high bare Pt South side the river – these two reaches rapidy current – NNW ¾ Limestone Rapid – pretty rough water, but deep – Steep Clay bank N Side – & Low flatt Limestone shore on the opposite – a Small Creek here on the North Side, at the Mouth of which observed the

1807

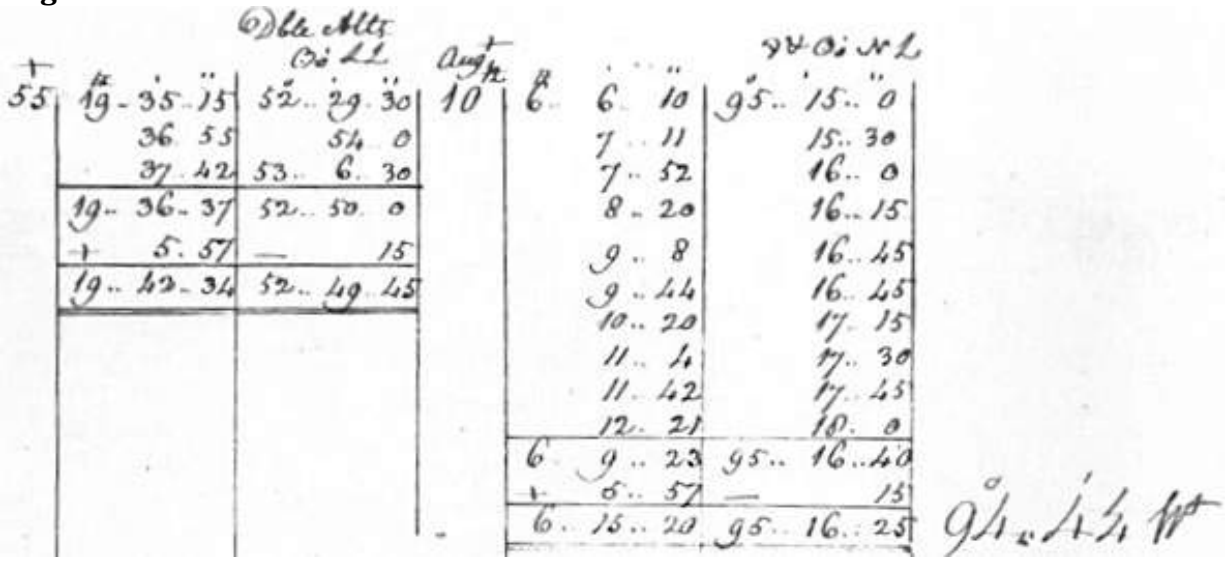
August 4th

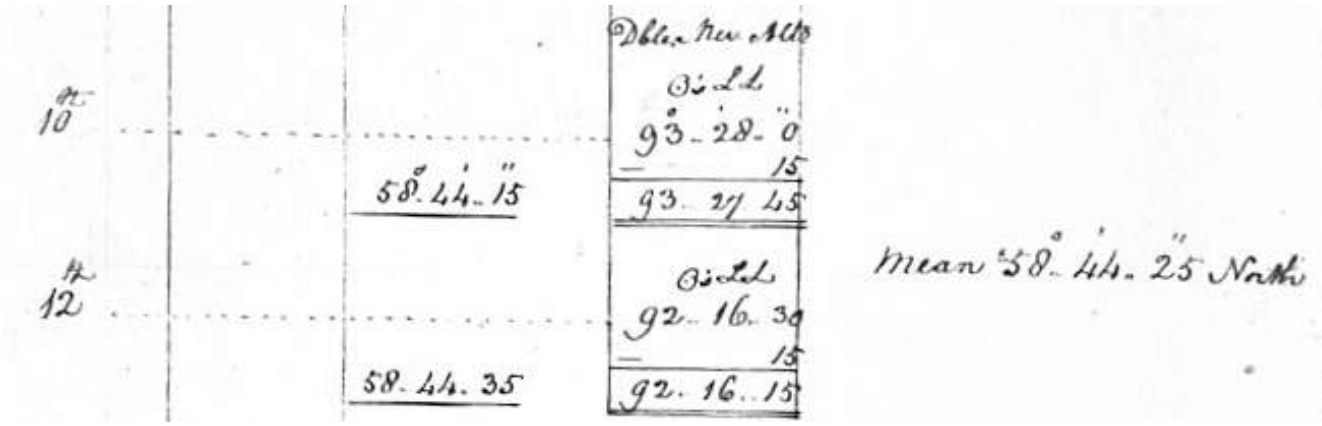


NNE 1 ½ strong rapidy current – N 2 the same – Governors Island on the Right – NbE ½ – NNE 3. & came among several small Islands & to the head of a large one on the left – NNE 3. & passed nearly the Deer Hedge Island – NbE 2 & passed the woody Islands on our left – river here ¾ mile wide N 2 several small Willow Islands – N 3 river nearly 2 miles wide, with pretty strong current & shoal – NNW 1 – NbW 2 – NNE 1 ½ - NNE 3 – NNE ¾ Musketto point on the left hand side – from which we see Churchill Factory – went across the Bay as it was nearly High water NW ½ N 4 & arrive at Churchill new Factory – at 6 Pm – all well. my foot which was bruised beyond Lake Wollaston, mending fast – I can now walk about tolerably well. – This river from the Factory to the upper end of the Four Carrying Places – is very rapidy bad road – Particularly above & below the Big Fall – it is generally 7 Days going up to where we came from this morning – Several Jepowyans here Mr Auld has got a far better Trade here this Year than has ever been since the place was settled in 1783 – Courses from the new to the Old Factory NbE 1 ½ Cuckolds point on left & a little below it Sloops cove on the same side – NNW 3 – Cape Merry on the right & the Old Factory on the left at the mouth of the river – a small Island there called Esquimeaux Point –

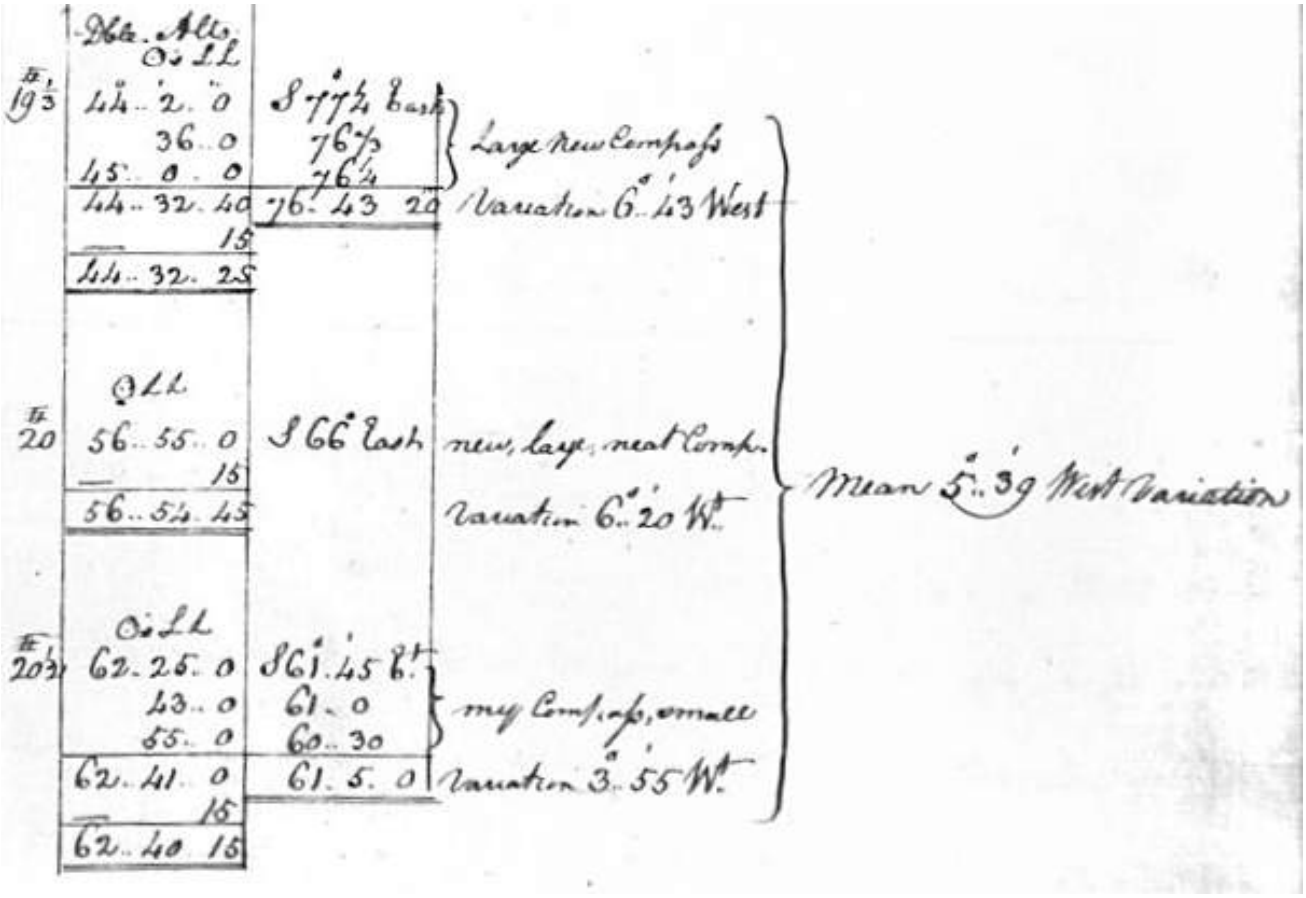
Astronomical Observations taken at Churchill new Factory by Peter Fidler

1807
August 9th





9th

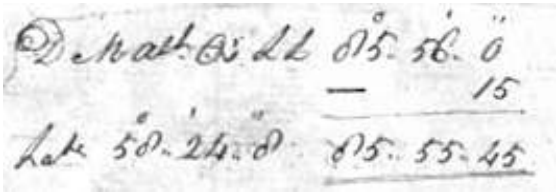


Made use of a Plummonet to observe these azimuths

1807

August 22nd Saturday – The three men who accompanied me all Summer – with two men from Churchill who are to return to Europe this Season – Embarked in an Old Inland Batteaux at 6#.35' Am, from the Old Factory. – we waited here, expected the Ship first here from England & to have sailed in her from this place to YF. last year she arrived here 9th Inst. – & not being yet arrived, we doubt but she may be gone first to York Factory – Sailed from the Mouth of the river – ENE ½ E 18 miles, & came opposite Knights hill & Beacon – an Island of Willows near it – Kept about 2 miles out from High water mark – many stony Reefs running direct to the Sea – with deep water between them – E ½ S 10 & came to Cape Churchill – levitate – a small gravel Island with a few Willows on it near the Point about 200 Yards long – saw 5 white Bears on it – shot one of them. – Rocky shore in several places between Churchill & Knights hill – no wood in sight – Turned the Cape at 1 ¾ Pm – rowed SEbE 10 – SSE 8 & stopped for the night, as it is very stony a long way from High water mark & the Tide ebbs 3 or 4 miles from the Land. –

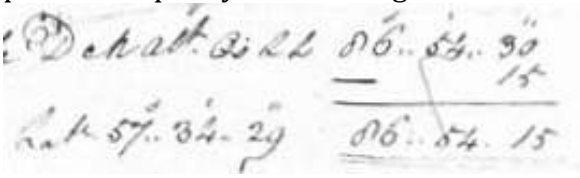
23rd Sunday – It was 7 ½ am before the Tide came & floated our Batteaux when we got underway – Rowed S 4 a large black stone about 1 mile from High water Mark, just covered at this Tide. – a gravelly Island a little farther on near the shore – SSE ¼ E 9



Two small gravelly Islands close in shore here – not covered at High water – SSE ¼ E 3 – SSE ¼ E 3 & passed the mouth of Broad River which opens WbS. – small solid rocky Island near the river mouth at Low water – Low stony shore near the mouth of the river on both sides – woods off about 7 miles in them – SSE ¼ E 12 & anchored our Boat out at Low water at 7 ½ Pm, that we might be ready to proceed as soon as day light in the morning – Aurora Borealis excessively bright this night, & nearly calm & quite clear –

August about 2 miles before we stopped for the night a very high gravel Island we passed on our left – a kind of channel amongst gravelly & small Stony Islands these 5 miles past – saw above 20 White Bears this Day – on the Gravelly Islands & on the main Shore. –

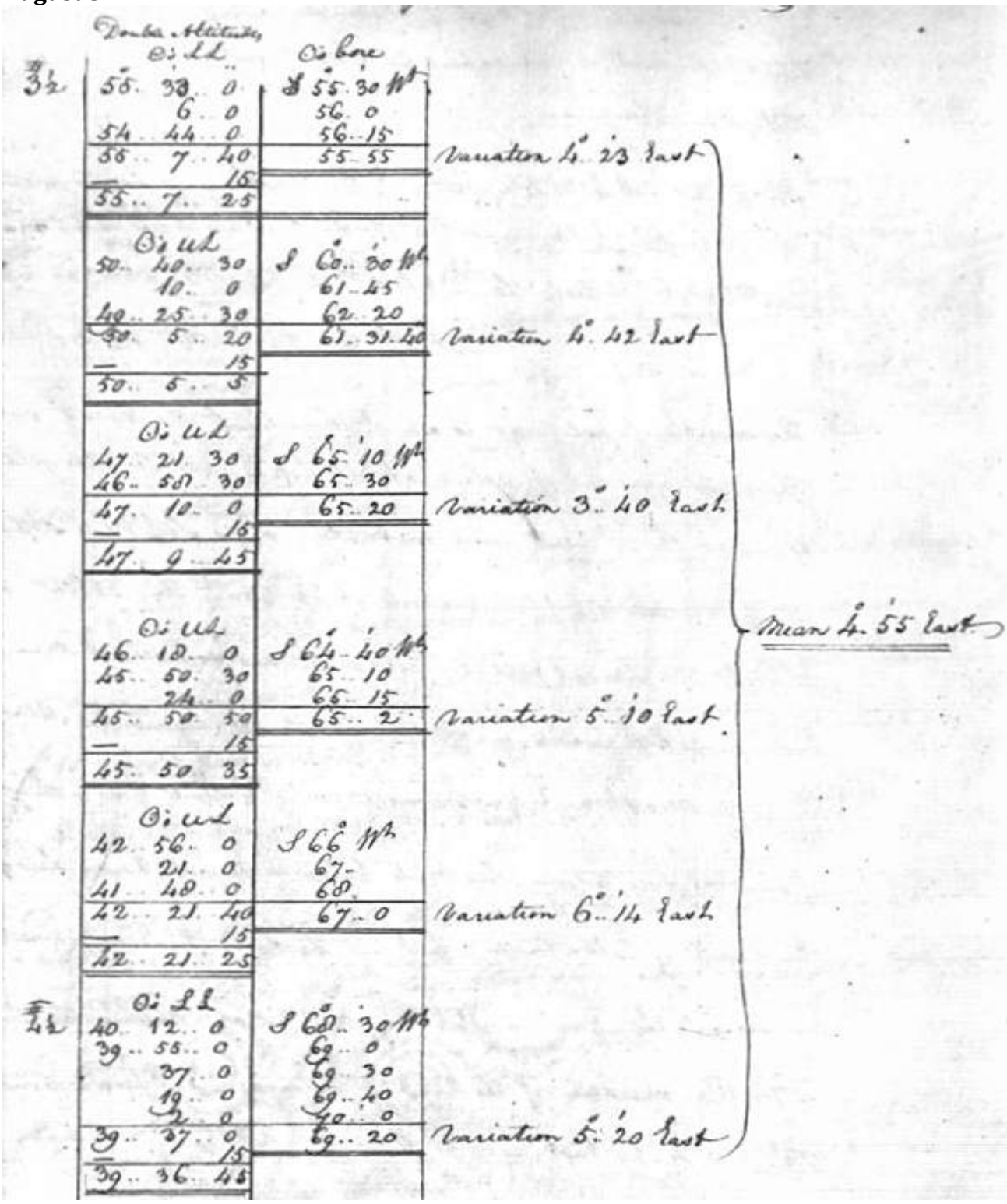
24th Monday at 4#.35' am took up our Anchor – & hoisted sail – a fresh breeze at NW. – SSE ½ E 16 – pines here pretty near the high water mark – SSE ½ E 16 SSE ½ E 6. & took the



The mouth of owl river is about 16 miles to the South side Broad river – The Northern end of Nelson shoals begin opposite this place – Embarked again at 12#.25' wind more moderate – saild SSE 17 & stopped about ½ Tide about the middle of Nelson Shoals at 4 ½ Pm – they extend too far from Land to keep on the out side of them with our small vessel – we are now 4 miles from High water mark – & cannot see beyond the Shoals – very stony in west direction & 4 or 5 small rocky Islands far without us – as none of us was ever along this coast before we do not know how far we are from the Mouth of Nelson river – but by the Land trending more Westerly we judge we are at the Northern Point of that river – Observed the Sun to Set N 73° or 74° W – Variation of the Compass allowing the Observed amplitude to be 73° ½ - is 4°.29' East. –

25th Tuesday – at 10 ½ Pm last night the Tide returned to the Boat – & at 11#.20' we got underway – rowing SbW 16 miles & came as we suppose opposite to Sam's Creek – Keeping in 2 ½ feet water the whole night – proceeded up the River against a head wind & ebb Tide – until we saw, after the fogg cleared up the Beacon at the Point of Marsh bear ESE. when we crossed the River & arrived at York Factory at 2 Pm – but no Ship yet arrived here from England. –

Astronomical Observations taken at York Fort Peter Fidler
1807
August 31st



Double Altitude	Azimuth	
☉ ll	☉ Bore	
3½ 55° 33′ 0	S 55° 30′ W	
6 0	56 0	
54 44 0	56 15	
55 7 40	55 55	Variation 4° 23′ East
— 15		
55 7 25		
☉ ul		
50 40 30	S 60° 30′ W	
10 0	61 45	
49 25 30	62 20	
50 5 20	61 31 40	Variation 4° 42′ East
— 15		
50 5 5		
☉ ul		
47 21 30	S 65° 10′ W	
46 50 30	65 30	
47 10 0	65 20	Variation 3° 40′ East
— 15		
47 9 45		
☉ ul		
46 10 0	S 64° 40′ W	
45 50 30	65 10	
24 0	65 15	
45 50 50	65 2	Variation 5° 10′ East
— 15		
45 50 35		
☉ ul		
42 56 0	S 66° W	
21 0	67	
41 48 0	68	
42 21 40	67 0	Variation 6° 14′ East
— 15		
42 21 25		
☉ ll		
4½ 40 12 0	S 60° 30′ W	
39 55 0	69 0	
37 0	69 30	
19 0	69 40	
2 0	70 0	
39 37 0	69 20	Variation 5° 20′ East
— 15		
39 36 45		

Mean 4° 55′ East

NB These Azimuths observed with the Beaver Brigs Large Azimuth Compass with string sights & cross hairs at right angles over the Center – It is very Old.

September 8th

	Double Altitudes
	Capella
11.. 30.. 34	67.. 30.. 45
39.. 51	56.. 0
40.. 53	68.. 10.. 30
11.. 39.. 46	67.. 55.. 5
— 10.. 12	— 15
11.. 29.. 34	67.. 54.. 50

Latitude 57.. 0. 20 N.

Increase 2nd Satt. of Capella 11.. 17.. 54 Sun weight
— 10.. 12
11.. 7.. 42

Longitude 92.. 13 ¾ West.